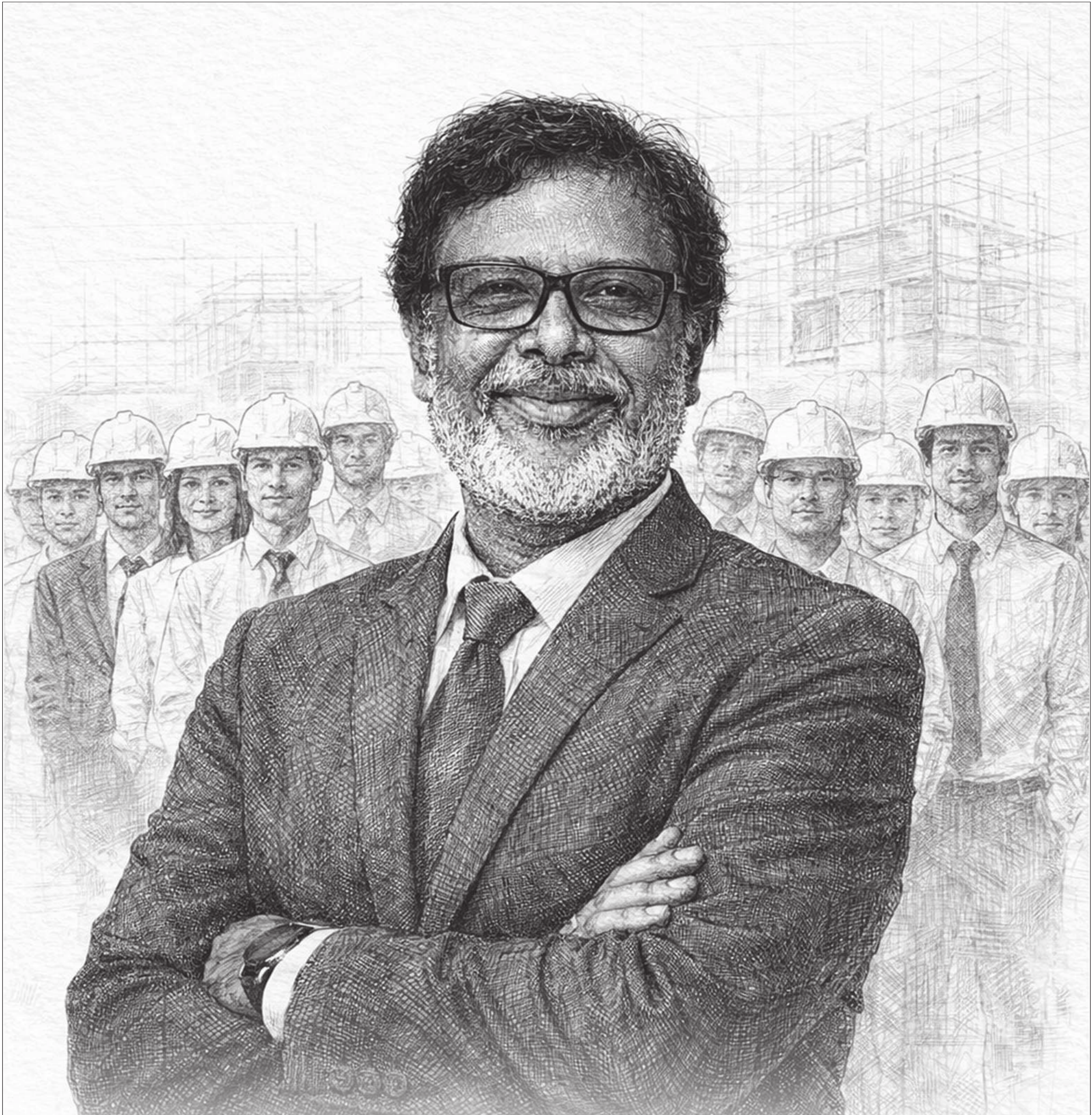




One man's **LEADERSHIP**

A TRAIL OF EXCELLENCE

R. Rajendra Mehta

BUILDING RELATIONSHIPS FOR A LIFETIME

Ex-Minister's
centenary
celebrated

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Former Minister K. Raja-ram's birth centenary was celebrated at an event on Wednesday. Speaker of the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly J.C.D. Prabhakar, Minister for Revenue and Disaster Management K.A. Sengottaiyan, Dravidar Kazhagam leader K. Veeramani, former Union Minister G.K. Vasan, Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT) founder and Chancellor G. Viswanathan, industrialist and philanthropist Nalli Kuppuswami Chetti, and former Minister H.V. Hande took part in the event at Kalaivanar Arangam.

 Timings	
CHENNAI	
THURSDAY, AUG. 27	
 RISE 05:58	SET 18:23
 RISE 17:54	SET 05:03
FRIDAY, AUG. 28	
 RISE 05:58	SET 18:23
 RISE 18:32	SET 05:53
SATURDAY, AUG. 29	
 RISE 05:58	SET 18:22
 RISE 19:10	SET 06:42

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	34	25
Chennai Airport	34	24
Chennai City	33	24

Chennai Airport Today
35°C The weather will be warm. Night also will be comfortable. Chances of light to moderate rain and thundershower.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
36°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be very warm. Night also will be comfortable. Spell of light rain and thundershower may occur.

© Copyright Skymet Weather 2026
All rights reserved.



Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE
(Survey & Construction)

No. COR-DRB-UMRA-T-02 Date: 24.08.2026
For and on behalf of the President of India,
Dy. Chief Engineer (Const-IV), North
Western Railway Hiran Magri Sector -11,
Old IOC Depot Udaipur-313001
(Rajasthan) invites E-tender (Single
Packet System) Closing date/Time
14.09.2026/15:00 for the following work
on prescribed form: - 1. **Tender No.:** COR-
DRB-UMRA-T-02 2. **Name of the Work:**
Carrying Out Final location Survey,
Geotechnical Investigations, Hydrological
Studies, design, Preparation of Drawings,
and Other Preliminary Activities for
preparation of DPR, EPC Tender
Documents for Chhitorgarh-Mavli-Debari
& Umra-Debari Double Line Project (99.00
KM + 24.782 KM) 3. **Mode of Tender:**
Single Packet System 4. **Estimated
Project Cost:** Rs. 2,22,55,758.20 5. **Bid
Security:** Rs. 4,45,100.06. **Completion
Period:** 180 Days 7. **Tender closing
Date & Time:** At 15.00 hrs. (IST) on dt.
14.09.2026.8. **Website particulars where
complete details of E- tender can be
seen:** www.ireps.gov.in Note : No
manual tender/s will be accepted.

1236-CQ/26

Follow us on:     [NWRRailways](#)  [NWRRailways](#)

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

DRM(Engg)/Adra for & on behalf of
President of India invites 06(Six) no. e-
tender for RUB, Depot, Extension, and
Misc. Works as mentioned hereunder. SI
No., Description of Works, Tender
Notice No., Tender Value: (1) **E-DRM-
Engg-ADRA-90-26**, Dtd.24.08.2026;
Construction of PWI Depot, Gang tool
room and side drain under the jurisdiction
of DEN/East/Adra; ₹ 6,41,29,897.52; (2)
E-DRM-Engg-ADRA-91-26,
Dtd.24.08.2026; Construction of Road
Under Bridge (RUB) in connection with
Development of Station under Amrit
Station Scheme at Adra Station of South
Eastern Railway; ₹ 9,56,81,810.05; (3) **E-
DRM-Engg-ADRA-92-26**,
Dtd.24.08.2026; Mohishilla(MOH)-
Damodar Kahi-Pahar-Provision of three
new full length line approx.750 mtr. at
Mohishilla station; ₹ 8,85,38,442.63; (4) **E-
DRM-Engg-ADRA-93-26**,
Dtd.24.08.2026; Replacement of
damaged sheets and painting of steel
structures including painting of the
existing building at Bokaro steel city,
Bhaga and Upgradation and Renovation
of damaged station approach road,
platform surface, Availability of water,
renovation of water Booths, Toilets etc. at
Layabad, Malkera Junction, Khanduhi,
Mahuda Junction, Kharkhari & Khario
P.H. over Adra Division. ₹ 8,68,63,577.58;
(5) **E-DRM-Engg-ADRA-94-26**,
Dtd.24.08.2026; Bokaro Steel City -
Extension of existing running Room at
BKSC and Installation of Electronic In-
Motion weigh bridge at KSU(Kustaur),
MHQ(Mahuda), KNF(Khanduhi) and
RDF(Radhagaon) stations of Adra
Division; ₹ 3,43,42,460.03; (6) **E-DRM-
Engg-ADRA-95-26**, Dtd. 24.08.2026;
Extension of existing platform length at
Bokaro steel city and Kotshila stations in
Adra Division; ₹ 4,94,01,318.63. **The
closing date and time** of e-tenders is on
25.09.2026 at 15.00 hrs. Details of above
e-tenders may please be seen at website
www.ireps.gov.in. (PR-673)

Ministers in-charge appointed to oversee development works

Minister Aadhav Arjuna, who is the Minister in-charge of Chennai district, has been appointed as the coordinator for all 15 zones in the Corporation

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government has appointed Ministers in-charge for all 15 zones in the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) to expedite development works and coordinate emergency relief and rescue operations during disasters.

According to a G.O. issued by Chief Secretary M. Sai Kumar, Public Works and Sports Development Minister Aadhav Arjuna, who is the Minister in-charge of Chennai district, has been appointed as the coordinator for all 15 zones, based on the directions of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay.

HR&CE Minister Ramesh is the Minister in-charge of Tiruvottiyur and Manali zones.

Commercial Taxes and Registration Minister D. Logesh Tamilselvan has been appointed for Madhavaram and Tondiarpet zones; Health, Medical Education and Family Welfare Minister K.G. Arunraj for Royapuram and Thiru-Vi-Ka Nagar zones; Minister for Handlooms, Textiles and Khadi M. Vijay Balaji for Ambattur, Anna Nagar, and Teynampet zones; Natural Resources Minister



The Ministers will coordinate relief and rescue operations during disasters. FILE PHOTO

T.K. Prabhu for Kodambakam and Valasaravakkam zones; Transport Minister A. Vijay Tamilan Parthiban for Alandur and Adyar zones; and Prohibition and Excise Minister K. Vignesh for Perungudi and Sholinganallur zones.

The government has also appointed IAS officers as Monitoring Officers to ensure access to relief measures during the Northeast monsoon.

K. Balasubramaniam, Director of Indian Medicines and Homoeopathy, has been appointed for Tiruvottiyur zone; P. Kumaravel Pandian, Member Secretary, Tamil Nadu State Planning Commission, for Manali zone; S. Arunraj, Additional Director, Directorate of Sugar, for Madhavaram zone; R. Kannan, Commissioner of Sugar, for

Tondiarpet zone.

Asha Ajith, Director, Environment and Climate Change, has been appointed for Royapuram zone; B. Ganesan, Managing Director, New Tirupur Area Development Corporation, for Thiru-Vi-Ka Nagar zone; K. Vivekanandan, Special Secretary, Industries, Investment Promotion and Commerce Department, for Ambattur zone; and B. Gayathri Krishnan, Director (Social Security Schemes), Commissionerate of Revenue Administration and Disaster Management, for Anna Nagar zone.

T. Christuraj, Director, Survey and Settlement, has been appointed for Teynampet zone; S. Gopala Sundara Raj, Additional Commissioner, Commissionerate of Land Administration, for Kodambakkam zone; J. Vijaya Rani, Director, Horticulture and Plantation Crops, for Valasaravakkam zone; Waghe Sanket Balwant, Executive Director, TIDCO, for Alandur zone; K. Senthilraj, Director, Adi Dravidar Welfare, for Adyar zone; Mageshwari Ravikumar, Director, Art and Culture, for Perungudi zone; and D. Baskara Pandian, Director, Museum, for Sholinganallur zone.



Doctors explain the medical procedures taken up to remove a breast lump in a 33-year-old woman, in the city on Wednesday. S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

Breast lump removed using vacuum-assisted method at city hospital

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Doctors at MGM Cancer Institute used a vacuum-assisted technique to remove a breast lump in a 33-year-old woman.

According to a press release, the woman was diagnosed with breast fibroadenoma. She had two benign masses in the same breast. One mass was located near the areolar region, while the other was in the middle portion of the breast.

Two different approaches were adopted considering the location of the masses. Doctors opted for open surgery for the one near the areolar region as some overlying skin along with a margin of normal tissue had to be removed, and ultra-sound guided Vacuum Assisted Excision (VAE) for the other mass. The minimally invasive VAE uses suction to remove certain breast lumps, avoiding scars, sutures, and breast distortion, the release said

M.A. Raja, director and

senior consultant, Medical Oncology, said that VAE is a minimally invasive procedure that can be used for removing very small lumps. This approach serves in both diagnosis and treatment. However, it would not apply to all kinds of lumps and depends on the size and position of the mass.

‘No scars’

Kirti Katherine Kabeer, consultant, Breast Oncology, who led the surgical team, said VAE leaves no scar and requires no sutures, that is important for young women.

“We have done VAE a few times in young unmarried girls. In this case, we confirmed that the mass was non-cancerous,” she said, adding that on follow-up, any change in shape or growth was monitored.

Swapna Matyam, senior consultant, Radio Diagnosis Department and K.S. Raja Siddhartha, clinical lead and senior consultant, Anaesthesiology and Surgical Intensive Care Unit were present.

Man from Guntur held for death of 32-year-old woman in Saligramam

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Virugambakkam Police have arrested a man from Guntur in Andhra Pradesh in connection with the death of a woman from Saligramam after he allegedly threatened to share her private videos and photos with her husband.

Police sources said the 32-year-old victim was found dead at her house on Monday. The police had declared it a case of suicide.

The police found that she had been in touch with Mohammed Hussain, 32,

and another man. They also found online money transfers from her phone to both the men. The woman stopped communicating with them in recent days, following which they sent audio recordings and videos of their conversations to her husband and threatened her.

Mohammed Hussain was booked for abetment to suicide. A search is on for the other suspect.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on the State's health helpline 104, Tele-MANAS 14416 and Sneha's suicide prevention helpline 044-24640050)



DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL - I
7th Floor, Additional Office Building, Shastri Bhavan,
Nungambakkam, Chennai – 600 006 Phone: 044-28490496

TRC No.: 06/2023 E Sale No: 02/2026

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE
(Under Rule 52(2) of Second Schedule to the IT Act, 1961 r/w Sec 25 to 29 of RDDBI & FI Act 1993)

The under mentioned properties will be sold "As is and where is/on what it is/no complaint" basis by on line e-auction through public e-auction on 15.10.2026 for recovery of a sum of Rs. 372,53,51,481/- (Rupees Three Hundred Seventy-Two Crores Fifty-Three Lakhs Fifty-One Thousand Four Hundred Eighty-One only) the dues as on 14.08.2026 from **M/s Pioneer Breeding & Hatcheries Pvt Ltd & Otrs to 1) M/s Pioneer Breeding & Hatcheries Pvt Ltd, U. Thimmaiyyan, D No. 1/15, Trichy Road, Pongalur, Thirupur. 2) Mr. V Thimmaiyyan, S/o PV Venkatasamy Naidu, B-4, Subbu Apartments, Race Course, Coimbatore – 641 018. Also at Flat No. 10-4, D Block, No. 17-A, Globus Anima Legend Apartment, SNR College Road, Nava India, Coimbatore – 641 004 3) Mr. P.V.Raghupathy, S/o, PV Venkatasamy Naidu, D.No.185, Trichy Road, Pongalur, Thirupur – 641 667. 4) Ms. Leela Krishnan, D/o, PV Venkatasamy Naidu, D.No.184, Trichy Road, Pongalur, Thirupur – 641 667. 5) M/s. Pongalur Feeds Pvt. Ltd, Rep. By its Managing Director, Mr. P.V.Raghupathy, S/o, P.V. Venkatasamy Naidu, D.No.185, Trichy Road, Pongalur, Thirupur – 641 667. 6) **Canara Bank, ARMB, R.S. Puram, Coimbatore, together with future interest from NEXT DAY in terms of the Recovery Certificate No. DRC No. 05/02/22 dated 10.06.2022 in O.A. No 100/2008, A Notice of Demand subsequently issued by the Learned Recovery Officer of DRT, Coimbatore and further transferred to DRT-1, Chennai on jurisdictional grounds and renumbered as TRC 06/2023, till the date of realization and the costs, charges and expenses of the proceedings for the recovery thereof.****

DESCRIPTION OF PROPERTY
All that Piece and parcel of the immovable property of Three Bed Room Flat No. 304, 3rd Floor, Legend Apartments, Old Door No. 177, New Door No. 255, with Built up area of 1550 Sq Ft situated at Poonamallee High Road, Chennai – 600010, together with UDS of 556.50 Square Feet of land out of 17818 Square Feet of larger extent of land, comprised in O.S 133 and R.S 381/3 & 380/2 of Egmore Village, Previously Egmore – Nungambakkam taluk, Chennai District. **North By:** Vacant land, Sold to N. Jayaraman and his sons, **South By:** The land belonging to Syed Ismail Ishani and others. **East by:** Part of the House of Mr. Gajapathy Rao and **West By:** 40 Feet Common Road. Situated within the Registration District of Chennai Central and in the Registration District of Periamet.

Reserve Price	Rs. 1,75,00,000/- (Rupees One Crore Seventy-Five Lakhs only)
Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 17,50,000/- (Rupees Seventeen Lakhs Fifty Thousand only)
Bid Increment (Multiples) of	Rs. 1,00,000/- (One Lakh and Multiples of One Lakh only)
Poundage Fee	2% up to Rs.1000/- & 1% on the sale amount in excess of Rs.1000/- as poundage fee to be paid by Demand Draft in favor of "The Registrar, DRT-1, Chennai – 600006." Within 15 days after conclusion of e-auction,
Inspection of Properties	On 23.09.2026 between 11 AM and 4 PM with prior information to the Nodal Officer of the bank.
Name of Bank and Account Number in which the EMD should be remitted through RTGS/ NEFT.	EMD shall be deposited latest by till 4 PM on 12.10.2026 in wallet Bank Asset Auction Network (BAANKNET) in https://baanknet.com . The EMD deposited thereafter shall not be considered for participation in the e-auction.
Submission of online bids	EMD shall be deposited and Linked / Map the EMD amount with the Property ID On or before on 16.00 Hours 12.10.2026
Date and time of e-auction Sale	15.10.2026 from 11.00 Hrs to 12.00 Hours with auto extension of five minutes till conclusion of the sale.
Name of website for uploading auction bid form and detailed terms and conditions-	https://baanknet.com
Contact name and telephone number of authorized officers for further queries regarding e-auction	1. Mr. Karthick Kannan M S Canara Bank, ARMB, R.S. Puram, Coimbatore, Mob. 9597171979, E-Mail ID: cb4712@canarabank.com.
Terms of payment on declaration as successful highest bidder-	The highest bidder shall have to deposit 25% of his final bid amount after adjustment EMD already paid in Wallet Bank Asset Auction Network (BAANKNET) https://baanknet.in within 24 hours and not later than 4:00 PM of next bank working day through RTGS/NEFT in the account of Indian Overseas Bank, Cathedral Branch, Chennai, Current A/c No. 16330200000550, IFSC No. IOBA 0000109 in favour of Recovery Officer, DRT.

The Balance 75% of the sale proceeds on or before 15th day from the date of sale of the property, exclusive of such day, or if the 15th day be Sunday or other Holiday, then on the first office day after the 15th day by prescribed mode.

The Sale will be governed by the Second Schedule of Income Tax Act, 1961 read with section 25 to 29 of Recovery of Debts and Bankruptcy Act 1993 and ITCIP Rules, 1962.

1. The auction sale will be "online through e-auction" portal <https://baanknet.com>. Sale will be by bidding through Online. Bidders are advised to carefully go through all terms and conditions of Sale given in the auction sale catalogue before submitting their bids. **UNDER ANY CIRCUMSTANCES BIDS IN PHYSICAL FORM WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED BY THE TRIBUNAL & NO ENQUIRIES WILL BE ENTERTAINED.**

2. The intending Bidders/ Purchasers are requested to register on portal (<https://baanknet.com>) using their mobile number and email-id. Further, they are requested to upload requisite KYC documents. Once the KYC documents are verified by e-auction service provider (may take 2 working days), the intending Bidders/ Purchasers has to transfer the EMD amount (After generation of challan from <https://baanknet.com> which will provide account details) using online mode in his Global EMD Wallet by at least one working day before the e-Auction Date and time in the portal. The registration, verification of KYC documents and transfer of EMD in wallet must be completed well in advance, before auction. Bidder's Global Wallet should have sufficient balance which shall be more than EMD amount at the time of bidding.

3. Prospective bidders are advised to visit website <https://baanknet.com> for detailed terms & conditions and procedure of sale before submitting their bids.

4. The Prospective bidder may avail online training from service provider :

Name of Auction Agency	Bank Asset Auction Network (BAANKNET)
Helpline Nos.	8291220220
Helpline Email Address	support.baanknet@psballiance.com

5. For other general information and details, please contact Mrs. Lakshmi V D/o Jayaraj Canara Bank Coimbatore Asset Recovery Management, Gujarat Samaj Building, R S Puram, Coimbatore, Mobile, +91 94968 09690, E-Mail ID - cb4712@canarabank.com, or Recovery Officer, DRT - I, 7TH Floor, Additional Building, Shastri Bhavan, Haddows Road, Nungambakkam, Chennai - 600006 (Phone 044-28490496; Email: no2.chennai-drt@gov.in).

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

a) Notice is hereby given that in absence of any order of postponement, the said property shall be sold on the above-mentioned date by e-auction and bidding shall take place through "On line Electronic Bidding" on the <https://baanknet.com>.

2. The sale will be stopped if, before the lot is knocked down, the arrears mentioned in the said certificate, interest and costs (including cost of the sale) are tendered to the officer conducting the sale or proof is given to his satisfaction that the amount of such certificate, interest and costs have been paid to the undersigned.

3. No officer or other person, having any duty to perform in connection with sale, however, either directly or indirectly bid for, acquires or attempts to acquire any interest in the property sold. The sale shall be subject to the conditions prescribed in Second Schedule of the Income Tax Act, 1961 and the rules made there under and to the further following conditions.

4. The particulars specified herein have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned, but the undersigned shall not be answerable for any error, mis-statement or omission in this proclamation.

5. The highest bidder shall be declared to be the purchaser of the lot provided that further that the amount bid by him is not less than the reserve price. It shall be in the discretion of the undersigned to decline/acceptance of the highest bid when the price offered appears so clearly inadequate as to make it inadvisable to do so.

6. Bids once made shall not be cancelled or withdrawn. The failure on the part of bidder to comply with any of the terms and conditions of e-auction mentioned herein will result in forfeiture of the amount paid by the bidder.

7. The sale shall be confirmed and made absolute after 30 days from the date of sale, provided all the terms and conditions of sale are complied with and the sale is not cancelled for any reason as per law. Sale certificate shall be issued to the successful bidder after the sale is confirmed.

8. In case of default of payment within the prescribed period, the deposit, after defraying the expenses of the sale, may, if the undersigned thinks fit, shall be forfeited to the Government and the defaulting purchaser shall forfeit all claims to the property or to any part of the sum for which it may subsequently be sold. The property shall be resold, after the issue of fresh proclamation of sale.

9. The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids if found unreasonable or postpone/cancel the auction at any time without assigning any reason.

10. The Property is sold on "as is where is/on what it is" basis, the prospective bidders are advised to peruse/verify copies of title deeds/documents the concerned branch of Certificate Holder Bank and they may make their own enquiries regarding any encumbrances, search results and other revenue record of the property and shall satisfy themselves regarding the nature and description of the property, condition, lien, charges, statutory dues etc before submitting bid.

11. Under any circumstances the property will not be sold below the reserve prices as specified in the sale proclamation notice.

12. No request for inclusion/substitution in the sale certificate of names of any person(s) other than those mentioned in the bid form shall be entertained.

13. All expenses incidental thereto shall be borne by the auction purchaser.

Important Note:

a) For any queries contact the numbers given at point Point No. 5 above. In case of no response then this office may be contacted.

b) When a sale certificate is issued by this authority under Section 85 of the 2nd Schedule of the Income Tax Act, 1961, it is the document evidencing the conveyance and it does not require registration. Hence, when a direction is issued by this authority for the duly validated certificate to auction purchaser with a copy to the Sub-registrar office to be filed in Book 1 as per S.89, Registration Act, 1908 then it has the same effect of registration and obviates the requirement of any further action. Therefore, the registration of the property by the auction purchaser is an option and not mandatory as per S.17 (2) of the Registration Act, 1908. [As held in 2021(2) CTC 493, 1990(3) SCC 605 by the Hon'ble Supreme Court of India and also held in WP No. 32749, 32361, 33019, 33020 and 3487 of 2022 and 1862 and 3195 of 2023, 2012(2) CTC 759 by Hon'ble Madras High Court.]

Given under my hand and seal of this Tribunal on this 24th day of August 2026.

**Balakrishnan Shanmugam, Recovery Officer – II,
Debts Recovery Tribunal – 1, Chennai.**

The Future Reimagined.
Discover. Decide. Define Your Career


PRESENTS

FUTURE CAREER CONVERSATIONS
THE NEXT-GEN DOCTOR

IN ASSOCIATION WITH: 

The future of medicine is being shaped by the powerful convergence of clinical expertise and technology. As AI, digital diagnostics, telemedicine and data-driven healthcare transform the industry, doctors must embrace innovation while keeping clinical judgement, empathy and patient-centred care at the heart of medicine.

Register now by scanning the QR code - limited seats available!
Webinar on August 29, 2026 | 4:30 pm onwards

The Future Doctor: Balancing Clinical Excellence with Technology

Panel Members



Prof. Dr R Jayanthi
Dean, SRM Medical College Hospital & Research Centre, Kattankulathur



Dr Vivek Narayanan
Dean (Dental), SRM Kattankulathur Dental College and Hospital



Ritubhan Gautam
Head - Global Health, Deep Tek.ai



Dr K Ganapathy
Honorary Distinguished Professor, IIM Jammu, Distinguished Professor, The Tamilnadu Dr. M.G.R. Medical University, Emeritus Professor, National Academy of Medical Sciences



Geetha Srimathi S
Senior Reporter, The Hindu (Moderator)



To register, visit:
newsth.live/THSRMFIP
or scan the QR code



However you look at it, Madraspatnam, a mere lick of sand, has magically transformed itself, over 387 years, into a nearly-dazzling metropolis of the future. The Hindu’s week-long Madras Day series is a celebration of the journey that Chennai has travelled through, over the centuries, marking the route it took to get where it is today. This city has changed - from how it looks to how it sleeps to how it does business, or even eats. It is a fascinating journey, as you will see. Happy Madras Day!

When mobility paves the way for city’s development

From operating one of India’s earliest train and tramcar services to nationalising public transport in 1947, Chennai has been a trendsetter in the public transport scene. Today, residents can choose from suburban, MTC, MRTS and Metro Rail services

TRANSFORMING CITY

R. Srikanth
Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Chennai has always been a trendsetter in the public transport scene in the country, be it the first train service to be operated in South India from Royapuram railway station to Walajah Road (now Wallajahpet) in Ranipet or one of the earliest tramway system snaking through the arterial roads of Anna Salai.

These were followed by the dedicated metre-gauge suburban trains linking the suburbs with the city and the ubiquitous buses of the Metropolitan Transport Corporation (MTC), which was earlier called the Pallavan Transport Corporation (PTC).

In between these services were the horse carts and the tricycle rickshaws, which slowly evolved into motorised autorickshaws. The autorickshaws were the best companion for those wanting to reach inaccessible areas in record time. Rajini-starrer *Baasha* even has a song dedicated to autorickshaw drivers. However, they have begun to fall out of favour with residents after they started fleeing commuters and with the advent of transport aggregators. Today, residents can choose from the multi-modal transport facility of suburban trains, the country’s first elevated transport corridor of the Mass Rapid Transit System (MRTS), bus services, and the quicker Metro system.

Stepping into its 387th year, the city has seen significant changes in its public transport scene, though several projects have been in the slow lane, including the MRTS, the MRTS extension project from Velachery to St. Tho-



City connect: In an ever-expanding city, the Metro Rail has become a sought-after mode of public transport among the youth and promises to improve urban mobility in the future. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

mas Mount, and the Metro. However, compared to the other metro cities of Bengaluru or Hyderabad, Chennai’s residents have dependable public transport facilities, particularly the MTC that, according to a senior official of the transport department, has the country’s largest network. It operates over 3,850 buses on more than 685 routes, and carries nearly 35 lakh commuters daily.

A senior official of the MTC said the passenger transport was nationalised in 1947 when the then Madras government introduced 30 buses. But in 1972, the State government hived off bus transport from the State Transport Department by setting up the PTC, registered under the Companies Act 1956, with a fleet of 1,029 buses.

Through the years, the MTC has transformed into a dependable public transport service and has introduced low-floor buses, with air-conditioning, and electric buses. To recreate the experience of travelling in the bygone days, it has introduced five retro buses for its city tour services called ‘Chennai Ula’.

Octogenarian R. Rangarajan of Pammal, sharing



It was an intelligent move to link all transport hubs, as it played a crucial role in drawing people to the Metro Rail system

K.P. SUBRAMANIAN
an urban planner

his experience of travelling in the tramways and the metre-gauge suburban trains, said the tramcars were the most convenient mode of transport as one could hop on and hop off wherever one wanted to. However, workers’ strike over wage demands caused the permanent closure of tramway services in 1953 and the launch of bus services, as the buses that were brought in to help break the strike took over.

Growth of Metro Rail
In the ever-expanding city, Metro services have become a sought-after mode of public transport among the youth. In 2015, nearly 15 years after the first proposal for Chennai Metro Rail was mooted, the first train chugged off from Koyambedu to Alandur. Though it was viewed as

a hallmark for development, the Chennai Metro Rail initially garnered only a lukewarm response and commuters took a ride just to experience these modern trains and stations. When the 45-km network of the phase I project was completed, many began choosing the Metro services since they connected the transport hubs – Chennai Central, Chennai airport, Chennai Egmore, and the Chennai Mofussil Bus Terminus. “It was an intelligent move to link all transport hubs, as it played a crucial role in drawing people to the system,” K.P. Subramanian, an urban planner, says.

Opening of the phase I extension network in early 2021 gave the much-needed impetus to its patronage, as it connected north Chennai – from Washermanpet to Wimco Nagar. Dayanand Krishnan, a commuter from Chitlapakkam, says, “Those from the southern parts such as Tambaram could board at the Chennai airport and seamlessly travel to north Chennai, avoiding traffic. It is one of the best transport connectivity in the city.”

The Chennai Metro Rail system, which once regis-

tered a footfall of 10,000 people, now sees an average of 3.4 lakh commuters daily. The number of people opting to travel by Metro has risen owing to its impeccable punctuality, both in maintaining the train frequency and in the cleanliness of stations and amenities, says Mr. Krishnan. “Be it at 5 a.m. or 11 p.m., commuters don’t hesitate to travel in this system because of the safety standards they have maintained so far,” he adds.

The 118.9-km phase II network with three corridors – Madhavaram to SIP-COT, Light House to Poona-mallee, and Madhavaram to Sholinganallur – holds a great promise of improving urban mobility in the coming decades. Mr. Subramanian says there has been a marked development in the corridors where the phase II stations are coming up.

“While the Chennai Metro Rail is focusing on transit-oriented development, wherein commercial complexes or office spaces are developed in and around a few stations, they can implement it more aggressively, in as many stations as possible. This will significantly change the way the city develops, and make it convenient for more people to access public transport,” he says. He stresses the need to work with the MTC to shift bus stops and operate buses back and forth from the phase I and phase II stations.

In the next 20 years, combined with the suburban, MRTS and Metro Rail services, and its extension lines such as Airport-Kilambakkam and Koyambedu-Adavi-Pattabiram, the city’s public transport scene is set to witness a sea change.



Serene space: The beach offers second chances to some, solace to the brokenhearted, and a sense of safety to others. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

In Chennai, the beach finds its way into love, grief, and heartbreak

Meghna M.
CHENNAI

The beach is woven into the lives of every person in Chennai. Whether a native or visitor, everyone is bound to have a beach story – about love, grief, solace, or even heartbreak. Come afternoon, Chennai’s beaches are dotted with couples sitting under umbrella to shield themselves from the sun and the watchful eyes of the public. “It’s easily accessible, free, and yet such a marvel. There are not many public spaces that are couple-friendly,” said Sid, 26, who visited the Besant Nagar beach with his partner.

For 27-year-old Srithi Sivakumar and her partner, going to the beach was a daily ritual. They would finish college around noon, and later go to Bessie – as Besant Nagar beach is locally known – catch the sunset, and eat a blue ice gola before returning home.

“If we got bored of Bessie, we moved to Thiruvannamiyur beach or Palavakkam. The coastline was a witness to our fights, our silly selfies,” she said.

The vast expanse of sand also meant safety for some. Shreya S., 35, had her first dates on the beach for this reason. “I’d meet people from dating apps at Bessie as it was close to my place and there was some sense of safety,” she said. As she got to know them, she would take them to

other beaches. “The drive to the beach would get longer in proportion to how much I liked them, beginning with Juhu beach, Kovalam, and finally, Mamallapuram,” she added.

It is on the same shore where love blossoms that hearts break, where the ‘soup girls and soup boys’ assemble.

Rohan Prakash recounted how the Loop Road and the Besant Nagar beach played a major role in his long-term relationship. “I was broken when it ended. I could not bring myself to go to the beach. But one day, I had to take the Loop Road and broke down crying in the middle of the road,” he said.

As one sits on the beach, the wind on one’s face, the sounds of the waves, and vendors’ calls replace rattled thoughts, offering a moment of calm. This solace was what brought Kirithi (name changed) to the Marina every day after a terrible breakup. “I’d sit by the shore and eat cotton candy. I didn’t feel alone as there was so much life at Marina and I would not be disturbed either,” she said.

The beach also gave second chances in love like for Sarath (name changed). “She picked the beach to meet. I had been pursuing her for quite some time to set things right and showed up with a bouquet of flowers. I asked her out again. She finally said yes,” he beamed.

In love and grief, the beach has come to mean many things for everyone; a safe space, a friend, and a guardian.

VANISHING THEATRES



Today, when we cross Anna Salai, we think of traffic, deadlines, and the rush to work. But for many in Chennai, the same road carries a different set of memories. There was a time when a theatre called Shanti stood here, attracting generations of moviegoers. The theatre became such a landmark that its name spilled beyond its walls and screens, and a bus stop nearby took its name. Read the full story on newsth.live/SHANTI

WHAT’S GOING ON

Madras Day Talk: Hyder Ali and the Seven Wells of Madras by Zhayynn James, Hotel Aadithya, 155/1, Arcot Road, Vadapalani, 6 p.m.

Exhibition: ‘Legacies - Memory, Traditions, Culture: Madras to Chennai’, curated by Ashrafi S. Bhagat, The Gallery at InKo Centre, 18, Adyar Club Gate Road, 6 p.m.

FROM THE ARCHIVES



Pallavan Express train flagged off

AUGUST 02, 1984
The Pallavan Express train, which made its maiden run from Madras today, was flagged off here this afternoon by a Class IV servant, Mr. Ganesan Servai. Having put in more than three decades of service, Mr. Ganesan Servai, a plumber, is due to retire by the end of this month.

E-Auction Notice for Leasing of SLR/LVPH

E-Auction notice no: LEASE-KGP-26-13 **Date: 25.08.2026**
For and on behalf of the President, Union of India, the Senior Divisional Commercial Manager, Kharagpur Division, South Eastern Railway invites e-Auction for leasing of SLRs/LVPHs for a period of 03 (Three) years for transportation of parcels in the trains which are notified in the <https://www.ireps.gov.in> website. **Category:** Parcel. **Catalogue No.:** LEASE-KGP-26-13; **Date of e-Auction:** 08.09.2026; **Auction Start Time:** 11:00 Hrs; **Auction Closing time:** 16:10 Hrs.; Interested parties and contractors to take note of this and go through the website as mentioned above for details of the trains and related information about the E-Auction notice. For enquiries / clarifications if any, please contact the office of the undersigned.

(PR-672) **Senior Divisional Commercial Manager/Kharagpur South Eastern Railway**
We serve with a smile

National Highways Authority of India (Ministry of Road Transport and Highways)

भर्ती सूचना / RECRUITMENT NOTICE
भारतीय राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग प्राधिकरण (भा.रा.रा.प्र.) संविदा आधार पर निम्नलिखित पदों के लिए आवेदन आमंत्रित करता है :-
National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) invites applications for following posts on contract basis:-

Name of the post	No. of posts*
सीनियर पेवमेंट डिजाइनर (भा.रा.रा.प्र.) सॉल्यूटिओन एक्सपर्ट Senior Pavement Design cum Material Expert	01
क्वांटिटी सर्वेयर (क्यूएस) Quantity Surveyor (QS)	01

*पदों की संख्या भा.रा.रा.प्र. की आवश्यकता के अनुसार बढ़ाई या घटाई जा सकती है।
*Number of posts may increase / decrease as per requirement of NHAI.

2. पात्रता मानदंड और अन्य शर्तें भा.रा.रा.प्र. की वेबसाइट www.nhai.gov.in पर देखे जा सकते हैं। Eligibility criteria and other conditions may be seen on NHAI's website www.nhai.gov.in

3. आवेदन जमा करना: इच्छुक और पात्र उम्मीदवार अपने आवेदन **28.09.2026 (सारांश 06:00 बजे तक)** भा.रा.रा.प्र. की वेबसाइट पर उपलब्ध लिंक के माध्यम से केवल ऑनलाइन जमा करें।
Submission of Applications: Applications are to be submitted online only. Eligible candidates may apply online on the link provided on the website of NHAI by **28.09.2026 (upto 06:00 PM)**.

4. इस विज्ञापन के संबंध में शुद्धिपत्र/अनुशेष/निस्सुकीर्ण, यदि कोई होगा तो, उसे केवल भा.रा.रा.प्र. की वेबसाइट पर प्रकाशित किया जाएगा।
Corrigendum/Addendum/Cancellation to this advertisement, if any, shall be published on NHAI website only.

BUILDING A NATION, NOT JUST ROADS



CINEMA ♦ ARTS ♦ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

Kartik Fine Arts
24997788 / 9840928049

Kartik Fine Arts, Narada Gana Sabha, Brahma Gana Sabha and Sri Parthasarathy Swami Sabha jointly present Nalli historical drama festival-2026. Today 6.30pm at Narada Gana Sabha Main Hall Tamilarasan Theatres “Baktha Prahalada” by Durai Balasundaram. Story & Dialogue: Kalaimamani K. P. Arivanandam. All are welcome.

Naada Inbam, 24992672
Voleti Venkateswarulu Birthday Concert by Malladi Suri Babu, Sayee Rakshith, Malladi Aravind, Trichy Murali. Today 6.15pm at Ragasudha Hall.

Narada Gana Sabha Phone: 24993201
Today Main Hall (Sathguru Gnanananda Hall) Drama - 6.30pm - Historical Drama Festival - Tamilarasan Theatres - “Baktha Prahalada” by Durai Balasundaram. Story & Dialogue - K.P. Arivanandam.

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

HOMAGE TO OUR REVERED HIS HOLINESS SWAMI KESAVAI AHJI FOUNDER SRI SAI BABA BHAKTHA SAMAJAM (Regd.) Estd. 1959
On the occasion of the **45th Aradhana Celebrations - Today (27.08.2026)**



Fusion Concert at 6.30 p.m.
by **Mandolin Maestro - U RAJESH & Vocal Sai Vignesh, Vocal Disha Prakash Percussion Siddharth Nagarajan & Party**
at **Sri Shirdi Sai Baba Mandir, Shenoy Nagar, Chennai - 30**
All are cordially invited to the Celebrations

ROTARY CLUB OF MADRAS TEMPLE CITY PRESENTS

A Nritya Harikatha
(A Cultural Presentation)

Sri U Ve Dushyanth Sridhar

Tickets ₹750 ₹500 ₹300 Booking through: MDnD.in

Fundraiser to support various charitable community projects

Date: Saturday, September 5, 2026 | Time: 5 pm to 8 pm
Venue: Sri Mutha Venkatasubba Rao Concert Hall, Inside Lady Andal School premises, Harrington Road, Chetpet, Chennai.

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

BRAHMA GANA SABHA, KARTIK FINE ARTS, NARADA GANA SABHA & SRI PARTHASARATHY SWAMI SABHA at Narada Gana Sabha Hall, Chennai

Nalli HISTORICAL DRAMA FESTIVAL - 2026
Today (Aug 27) 6.30 pm
Tamilarasan Theatres, Durai Balasundaram presents “**BAKTHA PRAHALADA**”. Story & Dialogue: Naataka Padmham K. P. Arivanandam. All are welcome. Tomorrow **LANKESWARAN**.

Powered by: **Nalli**

Sri Krishna Sweets

Jointly with **MADHURADHWANI**
TODAY 27, AUG. 6.30PM @ Arkay Convention Center Royapettah High Road, Mylapore

காலத்தை வென்ற கவிஞன்
தொடர் நடிகைகள்...
by Kalaimamani Isaikkavi Ramanan & Kalaimamani Rajkumar Bharathi
All are Welcome
Contact : 1001022343

CLASSIFIEDS MART

TO ADVERTISE VISIT
www.thehinduads.com
CALL: 044-28576300
TOLL FREE: 1800 102 4161
or Contact your nearest Authorised space sellers

PERSONAL CHANGE OF NAME

I, **JEEVA G** wife of hav Gaendiran A r/o Saduperi(vill), polur(tehsil), Tiruvannamalai (Distt), Tamilnadu-606907 have changed my name in army record from Jeeva G to Jeeva S vide affidavit dt 20-08-26, before notary public Arni (TN).

I, **M Annamalai** father of hav Gaendiran A r/o Saduperi(vill), polur(tehsil), Tiruvannamalai (Distt), Tamilnadu-606907 have changed my name in army record from Jeeva G to Jeeva S vide affidavit dt 20-08-26, before notary public Arni (TN).

I, **HARI Sankar**, S/O Venkatesan, born on 20--1996 residing at 7, Abu Garden, Thillai Nagar Main Road, Cuddalore-607308, have changed my name to Hari Shankar for all purposes.

I, **N.VENKUTU**, Son of Thiru N. Narayanaswamy, Born on 2nd May 1955. Residing at No 8/3 B, Soundarajan Nagar, 1st Cross Street, Keelkattalai, Chennai-600 117, Shall henceforth be Known as N.VENKITTU

I, **SANGEETHA RANGANATHAN**, Daughter of Ranganathan, DOB: 05/06/1984 residing at No.80, TVK Street, Redhills, Chennai - 600052, have Changed my Surname from “RANGANATHAN” to “MURALIDHARAN”. Shall henceforth be known as SANGEETHA MURALIDHARAN

FURNITURE
ALL SOFAS, All Recliners, Recondition, Reupholstery KNS Rajan 7667132323

PERSONAL OLD AGE HOME

PALLIATIVE CARE at your home Trained Nurses, 24/7, Dr., Physio visits, Lab tests 1800-313-1883 tikotra.com/seniors

SITUATION VACANT MARKETING

WANTED SALES Executives Leading Water & Wastewater Treatment Company – Chennai Freshers / Experienced Contact or WhatsApp your Resume to: 8438391401

PUBLIC NOTICE

Pursuant to the Litigation pending to set aside the alleged ex parte colluded compromise preliminary decree in O.S. No. 710/2011 (which is not final decree) on the file of the Hon’ble I Additional Judge, City Civil Court Madras, the alleged Receiver Mr. K. Sadagopan has no right to bring the property for sale at Old Door No. 180 and 180A, New Door No. 377 and 379, (Lloyds Road, (Previously Avvai Shanmugam Salai) bearing R.S. No. 69/3 (Part) Old. Survey Number 3146 (Part) measuring an extent of 5 ½ grounds Today’s market value is about Rupees One Hundred and Fifteen Crores. My Clients Mrs. P. Kannammal, Mrs. S. Vasumathi, Mrs. S. Vasudha Venkatesh and Miss. Amudha Parthasarathy are the major share owners of the above said Property. My Clients have filed necessary applications before the I Additional District Judge City Civil Court and Hon’ble High Court at Chennai. It is hereby informed to public that any false and frivolous colluded received bidding sealed covers by Mr. K. Sadagopan (alleged Receiver) or any alleged auction sale thereon will not be having any binding effect on my clients.

Mrs. P. KANNAMMAL
W/o. Late. K. Parthasarathy @K.P. Sarathy, Old. No. 60, New. No. 72, Bazulla Road, T. Nagar, Chennai-600017, Mob.: 9176622 479
M/s. V.S. RAMESH (Mob.: 9840383721) Advocate for the Legal heirs
Of Late K. Parthasarathy @ K.P. Sarathy, No. 151, Additional Law Chambers, High Court Buildings, Madras – 600104. E-mail: rameshvs1973@gmail.com

T.N. to take advanced healthcare facilities beyond city: Minister

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu will progress from treating illnesses to promoting “positive health” and take advanced healthcare facilities from Chennai to Tier II and Tier III cities, Health Minister K.G. Arunraj said on Wednesday.

Speaking at the launch of Apollo Speciality Hospitals, Teynampet, he said the government had so far focused on building hospitals and recruiting doctors and nurses. Now, the Chief Minister has insisted on a positive health policy that would give people access to information promoting health and well-being, regardless of income, he said.

He also said private hospitals such as Apollo were forthcoming in collaborating with the government in cancer screening initiatives, particularly breast cancer screening, across the State. Apollo Hospitals was among the first groups to contribute ₹1 crore when the Nalam TN scheme was launched, he said.

Apollo Hospitals on Wednesday announced the expansion of its flagship oncology facility at



K.G. Arunraj

Teynampet into a comprehensive multi-speciality hospital. The facility, previously known as Apollo Cancer Centre, has been renamed Apollo Speciality Hospitals, Teynampet, according to a press release.

Preetha Reddy, Vice-Chairperson, Apollo Hospitals Enterprise Ltd., said the expansion is to extend the expertise built over three decades of cancer care to complete healthcare for families.

Suneeta Reddy, Managing Director, said the consolidated model would enable multi-disciplinary teams to collaborate more closely in treating chronic and severe ailments that often require multi-organ management.

Harshad Reddy, Director (Operations, Group Oncology and International), also spoke.

Second cab pick-up point at city airport to open only in Sept.

AAI officials say that planning needs to be done for the opening of the plaza as the top brass from the Ministry of Civil Aviation will inaugurate it

PORT CALL

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

The wait to access the second cab pick-up point at Chennai airport grows even longer as it is set to miss the August deadline too. Though the facility is ready and has received approval, it is likely to get inaugurated only in September.

AAI officials said, since the top brass from the Ministry of Civil Aviation will inaugurate the event, planning needs to be done and hence the opening has been pushed to September. “It definitely won’t get delayed beyond September,” an official said.

Sources said that the AAI officials from New Delhi also want all the issues that passengers have been facing at Chennai airport to be resolved before the ministry officials come to inaugurate the event. The de-



Long wait: After missing the August deadline, officials say the inauguration won’t be delayed beyond September. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

lay to open this boarding point has been one of the biggest complaints of air passengers in recent times.

When the plaza is made ready, passengers from the T1 Terminal – which handles the majority of the domestic passengers – will find the cab boarding point accessible.

After this is done, AAI plans to shift the buggy vehicles from the T1 Terminal, and augment the number of such vehicles to the T2 International Terminal

and T4 Domestic Terminal.

“A small portion of the pathway from the T4 Domestic Terminal to the multi-level car parking facility still remains open to the sky and we will cover them so that passengers don’t get drenched in rain. This work too is going to be expedited and completed soon. Those who wish to take the buggy from the T4 Terminal will have it and the pathway too will be fully accessible,” an official said.

City’s sports culture is still going strong: MRF Ltd. MD

I grew up on Harrington Road. Growing up, it was such a quiet road, and we used to play cricket where the railway tracks were. And to see the road now, it’s completely commercialised with so many restaurants, shops, and it shows how Chennai as a city has evolved.

For me, Chennai is a lot about sport. It used to be cricket at school, cricket at home with my friends, and watching cricket. And also watching motor-sports...the race at Sholavaram is something we look forward to. Also, playing sports at the club was very important for me. I used to play sports at the MCC Club and the Madras Club.

The golf course is an important part of the city. I enjoyed playing golf growing up. When I used to play golf, there were just a few



Rahul Mammen Mappillai

of us, but now I see so many young children playing golf.

The entire CSK (Chennai Super Kings) phenomenon has made cricket special for the people of Chennai.

Now, you see a lot of new sports such as pickleball and padel. My kids play padel and pickleball a lot. The sports culture in Chennai is still going strong.

In Chennai, people we

meet have similar values. We don’t search for publicity; we believe in doing our work and doing it well. This is something unique about the city. And businesses here are long-term.

(As told to Sangeetha Kandavel)



From the archives: Playwright Pammal Sambanda Mudaliar with the cast of a play staged by SVS at Victoria Public Hall in 1927. This photo and more are on display at *The Hindu* Made of Chennai Archival Photo Exhibit as part of Madras Month celebrations. The exhibition will be on at *The Hindu* office till September 14 and is open to the public from 10 a.m. to 6.30 p.m. on all days, except Sundays. To visit, register for free at <https://madeofchennai.thehindu.com/>

Anti-drug awareness drive held at autorickshaw stands

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Anti-drug awareness programmes were conducted at 62 autorickshaw stands

across the city, with more than 2,000 autorickshaw drivers and members of the public participating.

As part of the government’s continued efforts to

eradicate drugs, the Greater Chennai Police are conducting awareness programmes at various locations to educate the public, youth and students

about the dangers and health hazards associated with drug use.

As part of this initiative, awareness programmes were held in six police dis-

tricts – Flower Bazaar, Washermenpet, Pulianthope, Anna Nagar, Koyambedu, and Kolathur – under the leadership of Sub-Inspectors.

Senior Advocate Krishna Srinivasan sets up law firm

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Senior Advocate Krishna Srinivasan on Wednesday said that he has set up a firm, along with his 15-odd associates, named KS Law Chambers, which would operate under the mentorship of A.L. Somayaji, former Advocate General, Tamil Nadu.

In a statement, Mr. Srin-

ivasan said, “I will, in my capacity as a designated Senior Advocate, act as an advisor to the firm, spearheading litigation. The firm will have four partners, Geethi Ara, Chitra Srinivasan, Hemanth Ragu, and Shashi Krishna.”

“About 15 associates/advocates and six staff members have migrated to KS Law chambers,” Mr. Srinivasan added.

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number
1800 102 1878

Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU thehindubusinessline.
FRONTLINE SPORTSTAR thehinduyouthworld THE HINDU

MANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED
(A Government of Karnataka undertaking)
Corporate Office, “MESCOM BHAVANA”, Bejai, Mangalore - 575 004
Ph: 0824-2885795 CIN: U40109 KA 2002 SGC 030425

No. E-347973 Date: 13.08.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION (THROUGH KPP PORTAL ONLY)

MESCOM invites tender for Manufacture & Supply of following materials:

Sl. No	Tender No	Name of the Material proposed for Procurement	Quantity
1	MESCOM/2026-27/JND0167	1.1 kV Polymeric Pin Insulators	1,00,000 No's

The interested eligible bidders may log on to www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in on or after 27.08.2026.

Sd/,
Superintending Engineer (Ele) (Procurement)

For Power Related Complaints contact:
MESCOM Helpline: 1912
9483041912 mescom_official mescom_official

PUNJAB STATE TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED.
Regd Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala. 147001
Corporate Identity No. U40109PB2010SGC033814 www.pstcl.org
O/o: Dy. CE/ TS (Design), Telefax: 0175-2207774, E-mail: se-trd@pstcl.org

Notice Inviting E-Tender

Tender Enquiry No.	STQ-7102
Procurement of 220kV Control & Relay Panels	
1. Last date & time for submission of tender- 25.09.2026 up to 11:00 AM	
2. Date & time for opening of tender- 28.09.2026 at 11:00 AM	

Detailed NIT/specification may be downloaded from Punjab Govt. e-tendering website <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in.nicgep/app>. Corrigendum, if any, will not be published in newspapers. As such the website may be visited regularly for updates.

1078/12/2026-27/14601 Dy. CE/TS (D), PSTCL, Patiala.

Debts Recovery Tribunal - I, Chennai
7th Floor, Additional Office Building, Shastri Bhavan, Nungambakkam, Chennai – 600 006, Phone: 044-28490496

TRC No. 06/2023 Dated : 24.08.2026

To,

M/s Pioneer Breeding & Hatcheries Pvt Ltd & Otrs to 1) M/s Pioneer Breeding & Hatcheries Pvt Ltd, V. Thimmayyan D No. 115, Trichy Road, Pongalur, Thirupur. 2) Mr. V. Thimmayyan. So PV Venkatasamy Naidu, B-4, Subbu Apartments, Race Course, Coimbatore – 641 018. Also at Flat No. 10-4 Block, No. 17-A, Glosus Arima Legend Apartment, SNR College Road, Nava India, Coimbatore – 641 004 3) Mr. P.V.Raghupathy, Slo, PV Venkatasamy Naidu, D.No.185, Trichy Road, Pongalur, Thirupur – 641 667. 4) Ms. Leela Krishnan, Dio, PV Venkatasamy Naidu, D.No.184, Trichy Road, Pongalur, Thirupur – 641 667. 5) Ms. Pongalur Feeds Pvt. Ltd. Rep. By its Managing Director, Mr. P.V.Raghupathy, Slo, PV Venkatasamy Naidu, D.No.185, Trichy Road, Pongalur, Thirupur – 641 667.

NOTICE FOR SETTING PROCLAMATION OF SALE BEFORE THE RECOVERY OFFICER

(Under Sections 25 to 29 of the Recovery due to Banks and Financial Institutions Act, 1993 r/w Rule 53 of the Second Schedule to the Income Tax Act, 1961)

Canara Bank, ARMB, Coimbatore ... Certificate Holder

– vs –

M/s Pioneer Breeding & Hatcheries Pvt Ltd, & Others ...Certificate Debtors

WHEREAS the Hon’ble Presiding Officer of Debts Recovery Tribunal, Coimbatore had forwarded the Recovery Certificate in DRC No. 05/2022 dated 10.06.2022 issued in O.A. No 100/2008. Subsequently Demand Notice was issued dated 03.08.2022 by the learned Recovery Officer of Debts Recovery Tribunal, Coimbatore for the recovery of the said amount. The Recovery Certificate has been transferred to this Tribunal on jurisdictional grounds and renumbered as TRC 06/2023 for the recovery of the sum of Rs. 237,84,44,521.50 ps (Rupees Two Hundred Thirty-Seven Crores Eighty-Four Lakhs Forty-Four Thousand Five Hundred Twenty-One and paise Fifty Only) the Certificate Debtors M/s Pioneer Breeding & Hatcheries Pvt Ltd & Ors together with future interest in terms of the Recovery Certificate dated 10.06.2022 till the date of realization and the costs, charges and expenses of the proceedings for the recovery thereof.

AND WHEREAS the undersigned has ordered sale of the immovable property standing in the name of Mr. V. Thimmayyan, Certificate Debtor No.2 as described in the schedule in satisfaction of the said Recovery Certificate;

AND WHEREAS on the date 14.08.2026 there will be due thereunder a sum of Rs.372,53,51,481/- (Rupees Three Hundred Seventy Two Crores Fifty Three Lakhs Fifty One Thousand Four Hundred Eighty One Only) excluding the cost of this sale, and interest and cost for the period from 15.08.2026 till the date of sale;

NOTICE is hereby given that, in the absence of any order of postponement, the said property shall be sold by the undersigned through public e-auction at 1100 Hrs to 1200 Hrs on the said date 15.10.2026 by the Debts Recovery Tribunal-I, Chennai; The sale will be of the properties of the defaulter(s), as mentioned in the schedule hereunder, and the liabilities and claims attaching to the said properties, so far as they have been ascertained, are those specified there under. The sale will be stopped if, before any lot is knocked down in favour of the successful bidder(s), the entire dues mentioned in paragraph above together with interest for the period from 15.08.2026 till date of sale and cost of this auction sale are tendered by the certificate debtors to the undersigned. At the sale, the public generally are invited to bid either personally or by duly authorized agent. No officer or other person, having any duty to perform in connection with this sale shall, however, either directly or indirectly bid for, acquire or attempt to acquire any interest in the property sold. The sale shall be subject to the general conditions prescribed in the Second Schedule to the Income Tax Act 1961 and the rules made there under, specific conditions found in the auction-sale booklet, sale notice published in the newspaper and to the following further conditions:

- The particulars specified in the annexed schedule have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned, but the undersigned shall not be answerable for any error, mis-statement or omission in this proclamation;
- The reserve price below which the properties, in a single lot, shall not be sold is Rs. 1,75,00,000/- (Rupees One Crore Seventy-Five Lakhs only).
- For reasons recorded, it shall be in the discretion of the undersigned/officer conducting the sale to adjourn it subject always to the provision of the Second Schedule to the Income –Tax Act, 1961.

SCHEDULE OF PROPERTY

All that Piece and parcel of the immovable property of Three Bed Room Flat No. 304, 3rd Floor, Legend Apartments, Old Door No. 177, New Door No. 255, with Built up area of 1550 Sq Ft situated at Poonamallee High Road, Chennai – 600 010, together with UDS of 556.50 Square Feet of land out of 17818 Square Feet of larger extent of land, comprised in O.S 133 and R.S 381/3 & 380/2 of Egmore Village, Previously Egmore – Nungambakkam taluk, Chennai District. **NORTH BY** : Vasanani land, Sold to N. Jayaraman and his sons. **SOUTH BY** : The land belonging to Syed Ismail Isphani and others. **EAST BY** : Part of the House of Mr. Gajapathy Rao and **WEST BY** : 40 Feet Common Road. Situated within the Registration District of Chennai Central and in the Sub-Registration District of Periamet.

You are hereby informed that the proclamation of sale has been promulgated and settling the terms thereof. You are requested to bring to the notice of the undersigned for any encumbrances, charges, claims or liabilities attaching to the said property or any portion thereof.

Given under my hand and seal of this Tribunal on this the 24th day of August, 2026.

(Balakrishnan Shanmugam)
Recovery Officer – II, Debts Recovery Tribunal – I, Chennai.

THE HINDU

DISCLAIMER: Readers are requested to verify and make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THE PUBLISHING PVT LTD, the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser’s products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

HPIDB HIMACHAL PRADESH INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT BOARD (HPIDB)

New Himrus Building, Himland, Circular Road, Shimla – 171001
(on behalf of the Department of General Administration, Government of Himachal Pradesh)

SELECTION OF AN OPERATOR FOR OPERATION, MAINTENANCE AND MANAGEMENT OF STATE GUEST HOUSE - “HIMACHAL NIKETAN” AT DWARKA, NEW DELHI

HPIDB, on behalf of the Department of General Administration, Government of Himachal Pradesh (the “Authority”), invites technical and financial bids online from eligible entities for out-sourcing the Operation, Maintenance and Management of “Himachal Niketan”, the State Guest House of Himachal Pradesh at Sector-19, Pocket-1, Dwarka, New Delhi.

About the Property:

A newly developed hospitality and accommodation facility on a land parcel of approx. 1.6 acres with a built-up area of approx. 2.1 lakh sq. ft., comprising 2 basement levels, 6 upper floors and a terrace, with 107 guest rooms (including 2 VVIP suites), student and drivers’ dormitories, a restaurant (80 covers), a banquet hall (300 persons), 2 multi-purpose halls, souvenir shop, office areas and 123 car and 89 two-wheeler parking spaces. The complete RFP Document may be downloaded from the e-Procurement Portal <http://hptenders.gov.in>. The Pre-Bid Conference is scheduled to be held on 05.09.2026 (11:30 AM) at HPIDB Office, New Himrus Building, Himland, Circular Road, Shimla-171001. The link to attend the meeting online shall be shared with the Prospective Bidders.

Site Visit:

Prospective Bidders may inspect the Property on any working day between 10:00 AM and 5:00 PM by prior email request to the Dy. Resident Commissioner-HP, New Delhi at rescm-hp@nic.in. Bidders are advised to regularly visit the e-Procurement Portal for corrigenda/addenda, which shall form part of the RFP. HPIDB reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids, or to annul the Bidding Process at any time, without assigning any reason and without incurring any liability to the bidders.

Chief General Manager
Himachal Pradesh Infrastructure Development Board, Shimla-171001,
Email: hpidb-hp@nic.in | Tel:0177-2626696

CASAGRANT
building aspirations
Presents
Made Of Chennai PHOTO QUIZ
THE HINDU GROUP
Co-sponsored by AU All India Finance Council

The photograph shows American guitarist Charlie Byrd learning to play the veena during his visit to Madras in April 1968. Who was the renowned veena vidwan teaching him?

Answer to yesterday’s Photo quiz:
Avvaiyar

Yesterday’s winners:
1. Subramani R
2. Praveen Uthayakumar
3. Bhavatharini E

Scan QR code or visit newsth.live/MOC2026PA to take the Photo quiz. Top 3 winners* every day win gift vouchers.

Associate Partners: ANSAR INFRASTRUCTURE, SRI SANKARAN, ORCHIDS THE EDUCATIONAL TRUST, SRI SANKARAN, CHINDUSTAN, TOYOTA, LICIOUS, StudyIn, etc.

Tamil Nadu

From Page One

SC youth’s death: CB-CID names six police officers as accused

However, alleging that Akash died due to police assault, his relatives staged continuous protests. Further, an autopsy revealed injuries at 28 places.

Police Inspector Dileepan and five other policemen were placed under suspension in connection to the death of the youth.

Subsequently, CB-CID police had been investigating the case under murder and SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, charges.

Meanwhile, the CB-CID police filed a chargesheet in the Madurai court on June 18. A copy of that chargesheet has now been received by Akash Delison’s family.

The document stated that the police took Akash to a eucalyptus grove near Manamadurai and assaulted him with an iron rod. He suffered a fracture on his right leg below the knee and above the ankle. Consequently, Akash Delison died due to a fat embolism in his blood vessels, it claimed.

‘Police hid rod used in assault’

Additionally, the chargesheet stated that the police hid the iron rod used in the assault and falsely recorded that he sustained injuries after falling while trying to escape from the police.

Six individuals – Inspector Dileepan, Sub-Inspector Guhan, and constables Kaleeswaran, Mahendran, Deiventiran, and Palaniappan – have been included as accused in this case.

‘Premeditated intent’

Akash Delison’s family alleged that the copy of the chargesheet was provided 68 days after it was filed, that it contained only 12 pages, and that all the documents recorded during the investigation were not fully provided.

The document added that the six police personnel had acted with premeditated intent, fully conscious of the victim’s caste.

INBRIEF



CEC to chair conference on electoral literacy clubs

Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar is set to chair a Regional Conference on Electoral Literacy Clubs and ECINET and hold an interactive session with booth-level officers at Kalaivanar Arangam in Chennai on Thursday. According to an official release from Chief Electoral Officer Archana Patnaik, the initiative, under the theme ‘Learn Democracy, Lead Democracy’, aims to strengthen voter outreach, foster constitutional literacy among future voters, and harness digital platforms for electoral operations. Deputy Election Commissioner Bhanu Prakash Yeturu, Director-General (Media) Ashish Goyal, and Director-General (IT) Seema Khanna will take part in the meeting along with the Chief Election Commissioner. The event will host nearly 1,000 delegates comprising students, educators, and heads of institutions representing 300 schools, 75 colleges, and 25 universities across Tamil Nadu and Puducherry.

At least 57 T.N. pilgrims stranded in Nepal; officials coordinating steps to rescue them

CM expresses shock over the devastating flash floods, and orders speedy and coordinated rescue efforts. Govt. announces helpline numbers. Founder of Isha Foundation Sadhguru Jaggi Vasudev says 148 people, who were part of a trip the foundation had organised, are in Nepal

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

At least 57 pilgrims from Tamil Nadu, as per available information, were among the Indians stranded in Nepal, where flash floods left behind a trail of destruction on Wednesday.

While a group of 21 people had reached out to officials seeking rescue, efforts were on to locate the rest of the party, as of 8.30 p.m. IST.

Meanwhile, founder of Isha Foundation Sadhguru Jaggi Vasudev said that 148 people, who were part of a trip the foundation had organised, were in Nepal, while 77 were at the immigration centre and three volunteers were in Timure, Nepal.

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay expressed shock over the devastating flash floods, and ordered speedy and coordinated efforts to rescue affected people from the State. He said he had ordered officials at Tamil Nadu House in New Delhi to coordinate the rescue operation.



Nature’s fury: Flash floods left behind a trail of destruction in Nepal on Wednesday. AP

The State government also announced round-the-clock, toll-free helpline numbers for affected family members to coordinate with officials. According to a release from the Department of Welfare of Non-Resident Tamils, the helpline number for calls within India is 1800 309 3793. Those calling from abroad can give a missed call to +91 80690 09900 or call +91 80690 09901. Those who want to reach the control room at the Tamil Nadu House in New Delhi can contact 92895 16712.

Meanwhile, the Thanjavur, Tiruvarur, and Mayiladuthurai district administrations had started collecting the address and other details of the tourists from the respective districts, and were co-ordinating with the Central government, official sources said. Eleven persons from

The 57 pilgrims went to Nepal on a tour organised by a Kumbakonam-based company in a tie-up with a Nepal-based company. They landed in Nepal a few days ago, and were heading towards the Tibet border when the flash floods occurred.

Divided into three groups, they travelled on three buses to the Tibet border, sources said. While 21 of them managed to get shelter at a Nepal border police outpost, the status of the others was yet to be ascertained, according to an official spokesperson of the travel company.

Meanwhile, the Thanjavur, Tiruvarur, and Mayiladuthurai district administrations had started collecting the address and other details of the tourists from the respective districts, and were co-ordinating with the Central government, official sources said. Eleven persons from

Chidambaram and Bhuvanagiri in Cuddalore district were among the pilgrims from Tamil Nadu stranded in Nepal.

On Wednesday evening, Sadhguru Jaggi Vasudev said that of the 21 groups that were part of the trip, 495 people had returned safely, while 743 were in Tibet, 148 in Nepal, 77 at the immigration centre, and three volunteers in Timure, Nepal.

“All of us, including the volunteers and support teams, are deeply anguished and are doing our utmost to assist in the rescue. There has been no official information on the whereabouts of any of the people who were at the immigration office. We are working with the authorities to see if we can get to the location, and stand ready to be part of the rescue efforts, regardless of the risk involved,” he said.

T. Sugumar, 71, of Mayi-

laduthurai, whose wife, S. Manimekalai, 64, had gone on a tour to Kailash, said his wife had said on Wednesday that she was safe somewhere on the Nepal border. There were 19 others with Ms. Manimekalai, and they had travelled in the same vehicle before the incident was reported.

“The call from my wife came around 11 a.m.,” said Mr. Sugumar. She could not be contacted thereafter, he added.

Another traveller from Mayiladuthurai district was Pushpalatha, 60, of Kazhukaanimattam. Her relative, Ramesh, said she made a WhatsApp call in the morning, saying she was safe. “After the incident was reported, we called the official helpline number and were told that she was safe,” Mr. Ramesh said.

(With inputs from Coimbatore, Cuddalore and Tiruchi).

Enhanced insurance coverage to be rolled out soon: Minister

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Health Minister K.G. Arunraj on Wednesday said the recently announced increase in insurance coverage under the Chief Minister’s Comprehensive Health Insurance Scheme (CMCHIS) from ₹5 lakh to ₹25 lakh will be implemented soon. New insurance cards will not be required, and beneficiaries can continue to use their existing cards, he said.

After inaugurating two lecture halls renovated at a cost of ₹1.50 crore at Madras Medical College, he said the increase in coverage from ₹5 lakh to ₹25 lakh did not mean the insurance premium will increase five-fold, as the number of families requiring advanced treatment and filing claims was likely to be low. Necessary funds will be allocated for this purpose, he said, according to a press release.

Dr. Arunraj said in-vitro fertilisation (IVF) centres will be expanded to more district government hospitals.

He said the shortage of

chemotherapy drugs would be addressed.

The Minister said the public need not fear H1N1 influenza and dengue. Last year, the number of cases was high during January-April, while this year, infections had been reported during May-July. “The higher number of reported cases is also attributed to the increased number of fever tests being conducted. All necessary precautionary measures have been taken at government hospitals,” he said.

Dengue precautions

As it is the monsoon season, the public should ensure that water does not stagnate around their homes. Precautions should be taken to prevent dengue transmission by Aedes mosquitoes, which are day-biting mosquitoes. Fever camps will be conducted for school students. Those experiencing fever along with headache, vomiting, or severe body pain should immediately seek medical advice at the nearest government hospital or primary health centre, he said.

There has been ‘no corruption or virtually nil corruption’ at many govt. offices, says Chidambaram

T. Ramakrishnan
K. Muralitharan
CHENNAI

Congress Rajya Sabha member and former Union Minister for Finance and Home Affairs, P. Chidambaram, on Wednesday said there had been “no corruption or virtually nil corruption” at offices of the Registration Department and the State power utility after the TVK came to power.

Citing public feedback as the source of his information, Mr. Chidambaram, in an interview with *The Hindu* 360, the Tamil YouTube channel of *The Hindu*, said that during his interactions with people in his home district of Sivaganga, he heard that there was “no corruption” at the time of registration of documents or in teachers’ transfers. “Corruption has almost been eliminated at the offices of the Electricity Board. I also understand that sanctions for the appointment of teachers in [government-aided] schools and colleges have been sent by post,” he said.

He was replying to a question on his assessment



Senior Congress leader P. Chidambaram speaking to *The Hindu* 360, the Tamil YouTube channel of *The Hindu*. THAMODHARAN B.

of the functioning of the State government. “Only 105 days have passed,” Mr. Chidambaram said, adding, “It is a short period.”

To a question on the 2026 Assembly election result, he said political parties, the media, and commentators had failed to read the political scenario, and had been under the impression that the two Dravidian parties – the DMK and the AIADMK – were occupying 80% of the space. “What they held was 80% of the legislature space in view of the two parties sharing between themselves nearly 200 Assembly seats all these years, but not 80% of the political space,” he said.

On the role of Gen Z, he

said: “This time, they all exercised their franchise.” In his constituency, for instance, by 11 a.m. on polling day, Gen Z had finished casting their votes, he said.

On the need for continuing subsidies, he said, “If there are externalities, we can welcome the scheme. In the absence of externalities, the scheme can be rejected.” For instance, with the free bus travel for women scheme, he pointed out that in Karaikudi, where a women’s law college had come up, people from villages within a 25-km radius had said that if not for the bus service, they would not have sent their girl children to college. “So, the scheme has externalities,” he said.

CM to release water from Mettur dam on September 1

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay will release water from Stanley Reservoir in Mettur for irrigation in the Cauvery delta on September 1.

Minister for Water Resources N. Anand said water will be released for 45 days. He said the decision had been taken considering the State’s drinking water requirements and irrigation needs of the Cauvery delta, despite inadequate rainfall in the Cauvery basin during the southwest monsoon.

To secure Tamil Nadu’s rightful share of Cauvery water, the government took firm legal and administrative measures, and had presented its stand before the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee and the Cauvery Water Management Authority. Steps were also taken to protect the State’s legitimate rights by approaching the Supreme Court and, as a result of these continued efforts, orders were obtained to ensure that Tamil Nadu receives its due share of water, the Minister said.

Property attachment under TANPID Act takes precedence over attachment under money laundering charges: HC

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court has come to the rescue of thousands of depositors duped by fraudulent financial institutions by holding that attachment of properties under the Tamil Nadu Protection of Interests of Depositors (In Financial Establishments) Act of 1997 (TANPID Act) would take precedence over the attachment of the same properties under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) of 2002.

A Division Bench of Justices G.R. Swaminathan and V. Lakshminarayanan ruled that the attachments made by the Directorate of Enforcement (ED) by invoking the provisions of PMLA could not be allowed to prevail over the attachments made by a District Revenue Officer



The court disposed of a case filed for expeditious sale of five properties belonging to Viswapriya (India) Limited.

under the TANPID Act just because the former legislation was passed by Parliament and the latter by the State legislature.

The verdict was passed while disposing of a case filed for expeditious sale of five properties belonging to Viswapriya (India) Limited, one of the many companies founded by R. Subramanian of the now-defunct Subhiksha

chain of retail provision stores. The judges took note that 34 out of 1,240 depositors of Viswapriya Limited had died since most of them were senior citizens who had invested their retiral benefits.

Though the ED objected to the sale since it had also attached the same properties, the judges said the Supreme Court had on April 12, 2019, stayed the proceedings initiated against Mr. Subramanian under PMLA and therefore, as on date, the action initiated by the agency had been put on hold.

Explaining the reasons, Justice Swaminathan said Section 14 of TANPID Act categorically states that the Act shall have effect notwithstanding anything inconsistent therewith contained in any other law. Further, the Supreme Court had upheld the va-

lidity of the Act in 2011 after taking into account that it had been enacted to ameliorate the condition of thousands of depositors who had fallen into the clutches of fraudulent financial establishments.

The senior judge in the Bench also recalled that the Supreme Court had in 2025 held that central legislations such as the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest (SARFAESI) Act of 2002 and Recovery of Debts and Bankruptcy Act of 1993 could not be permitted to prevail over the Maharashtra Protection of Interest of Depositors (in Financial Establishments) Act of 1999.

Further, Justice Swaminathan said Section 3 of the TANPID Act, dealing with attachment of properties, begins with a non-ob-

stante clause, ‘Notwithstanding anything contained in any other law for the time being in force,’ whereas Section 5 of the PMLA, dealing with attachment of properties, does not have any non-obstante clause though a few other provisions of the central law do begin with such a clause.

“Having incorporated the non-obstante clauses in specific provisions, the omission to do so in the case of attachments appears to be deliberate and significant. An attachment passed under TANPID Act has the shield of non-obstante clause, whereas the attachment provision under PMLA is lacking in such armoury,” the judge said.

He ordered liquidation of the properties of Viswapriya (India) Limited attached under the TANPID Act.

‘T.N. government actively pursuing V-C appointment issue in courts’

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The State government has been taking all necessary steps to find a solution to the impasse over appointment of Vice-Chancellors to State-run universities, Higher Education Minister P. Viswanathan told the Assembly recently.

Taking part in the debate on the demand for grants for the Higher Education Department, he said the issue had been caught up in litigation at the Madras High Court, and the government was taking steps, legally and administratively, to find a solution.

Twelve out of 13 universities in the State, with the exception of Mother Teresa Women’s University, have been functioning without Vice-Chancellors for several years, with Ma-

nonmaniam Sundaranar University and Alagappa University being the latest to be added to the list.

Mr. Viswanathan also announced that the government would implement a Career Advancement Scheme (CAS) for teachers of government-aided arts and science colleges, government and government-aided engineering colleges, and polytechnic colleges from September 1, with prospective effect. This has been a long-standing issue for the department, with teachers of government-aided colleges staging multiple agitations over the years, demanding the implementation of CAS.

The Minister announced that the government would take steps to fill the 6,000-plus vacancies in government arts

and science and technical institutions through the Teachers’ Recruitment Board in three phases. Besides, the ongoing process of recruitment of 2,708 assistant professors to government arts and science colleges will be completed soon. The honorarium of guest lecturers in government arts and science and technology institutions has been raised from ₹30,000 to ₹35,000 with immediate effect, while guest lecturers in polytechnic colleges will get ₹30,000, up from ₹25,000.

Mr. Viswanathan also announced the setting up of the Periyar Institute of Emerging Technologies (PIET) on the Anna University campus. The government will also enact a law to set up a School of Excellence for education and research in basic sciences.

INBRIEF



Naidu asks officials to roll out Sanjeevani project from Jan. 1

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu has directed officials to roll out the Sanjeevani project, aimed at strengthening healthcare services through digital health records and Artificial Intelligence-based interventions, across Andhra Pradesh from January 1, 2027. Reviewing the project with the officials on Wednesday, Mr. Naidu said the initiative should be implemented effectively to bring about a major transformation in healthcare delivery.

Hyderabad firm gets ₹1,600 crore order from Rolls-Royce

Aerospace and defence components maker Sigma Advanced Systems, a Hyderabad-based company, said it has secured a nearly £125 million (around ₹1,600 crore) long-term contract from Rolls-Royce through its UK subsidiary Bromford Precision Solutions. Under the agreement, Bromford will manufacture various critical engine structures at Sigma's India and UK manufacturing facilities.

HC quashes charges against homestay owner in rape case

The Karnataka High Court has quashed criminal proceedings against the owner of a homestay in Kodagu, who was accused of failing to report to the police the alleged rape of a U.S. national at his property in April and not maintaining registration form about her stay. The court found that the petitioner was under no statutory obligation to report the alleged sexual assault, distinguishing the case from statutes like the POCSO, which expressly create such a duty on anyone who has the knowledge of such offences.

Minister facing graft charges may quit Karnataka Cabinet

Opposition has been demanding his resignation over his alleged role in Valmiki scam; Governor has sought clarity on his continuation; issue may come up during CM's meet with Cong. top brass

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A day after the BJP and the JD(S) announced a *padayatra* from September 1, reports have emerged that Planning and Statistics Minister B. Nagendra is likely to resign from the Karnataka Cabinet.

The Opposition has been demanding Mr. Nagendra's resignation over his alleged role in the embezzlement of funds from the Maharshi Valmiki Scheduled Tribe Development Corporation, an issue that dominated the recently concluded legislature session.

The possibility of Governor Thaawarchand Gehlot



BJP workers demanding the resignation of Minister B. Nagendra over his alleged involvement in the scam on Monday. FILE PHOTO

granting sanction for Mr. Nagendra's prosecution, following a plea by the CBI, is also believed to have prompted the Minister to consider stepping down. The Governor has reportedly written to the State Cabinet seeking clarity on Mr. Nagendra's continua-

tion in the Ministry. The Enforcement Directorate has already filed a chargesheet in the alleged multi-crore scam in the Corporation.

Sources in the Congress told *The Hindu* that Mr. Nagendra had spoken to Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar

and expressed his desire to resign. To a question from presspersons on the possibility of Mr. Nagendra's resignation, Mr. Shivakumar said, "There is no such proposal at the moment. All party workers, MLAs and Ministers are disciplined soldiers of the party. We have faith in his leadership."

Mr. Shivakumar is scheduled to travel to Delhi on Thursday, where the issue of Mr. Nagendra's resignation is expected to figure in his discussions with top brass of the party including Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge.

He is also likely to seek approval for filling a vacant Cabinet position with a woman legislator.

Six dead as bus rams truck in Telangana

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Six passengers were killed and 12 injured when a bus rammed into a container truck carrying electric poles near Kodad in Telangana early on Wednesday.

The accident occurred when the private bus, operated by Fresh Bus, was travelling from Hyderabad to Eluru via Vijayawada.

The bus rammed the

rear of a truck, reportedly while speeding to overtake another vehicle.

The impact caused the poles from the truck to enter the bus, crushing the driver and a portion of the passenger compartment, the police said.

Expressing shock over the incident, Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy instructed officials to extend all necessary assistance to the victims.

Missing A.P. fishermen found in West Bengal

The Hindu Bureau
ODALAREVU

Seven fishermen from Andhra Pradesh, who went missing in the sea on August 7, were found near Shankarpur fishing harbour off the West Bengal coast on Wednesday.

Contact was lost with the fishermen on August 7 after they went deep-sea fishing off the Andhra Pradesh coast. Navy and Coast

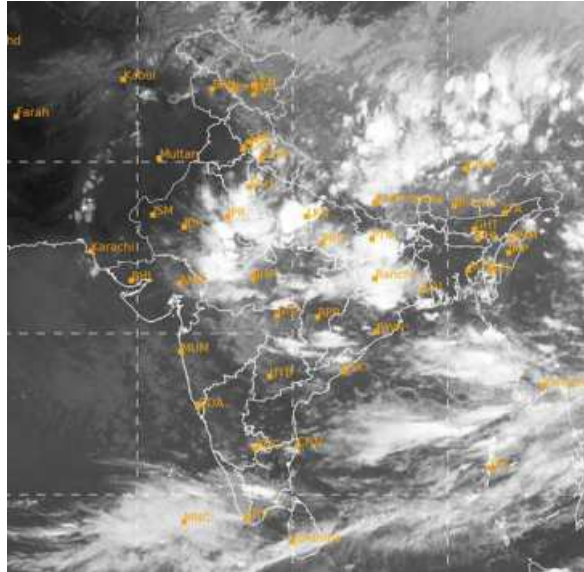
Guard had been conducting search operations since August 17.

On Wednesday, local fishermen found the missing fishermen in their boat near the Shankarpur fishing harbour. The missing fishermen said that they were stranded at sea after the engine of the boat developed a snag.

Officials are in touch with the Bengal authorities to ensure their safe return.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Thursday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Kerala and Mahe. Thunderstorm with lightning & gusty winds likely at isolated places over Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu and Puducherry

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	0.2	36.0	26.4	Kurnool	0.2	35.2	25.9
Ahmedabad	—	34.1	26.6	Lucknow	27	32.1	27.0
Aizawl	—	32.9	23.9	Madurai	—	38.0	27.1
Bengaluru	0.6	29.5	20.4	Mangaluru	8.9	29.0	24.6
Bhopal	1	27.8	23.6	Mumbai	—	32.2	26.9
Bhubaneswar	52	33.0	26.2	Mysuru	—	29.8	19.8
Chandigarh	58.7	35.0	24.4	New Delhi	8.8	33.8	26.5
Chennai	—	36.7	27.0	Patna	0.5	32.8	28.8
Coimbatore	0.4	31.0	22.1	Port Blair	9.3	28.5	25.6
Dehradun	1.7	32.2	23.8	Prayagraj	21.7	32.8	26.6
Gangtok	10.2	21.8	18.9	Puducherry	—	37.2	27.5
Goa	11	31.6	25.5	Pune	3.6	29.8	22.1
Guwahati	—	35.7	27.1	Raipur	6.2	32.0	25.5
Hubballi	—	29.0	22.0	Ranchi	1	29.6	23.0
Hyderabad	7	30.9	23.0	Shillong	0.2	24.6	19.3
Imphal	0.9	32.3	22.9	Shimla	10.8	26.6	20.0
Jaipur	1.2	34.1	26.6	Srinagar	—	32.7	17.6
Kochi	—	28.2	24.8	Thiruvananthapuram	11.9	30.2	23.7
Kohima	—	26.0	20.0	Tiruchirappalli	—	38.5	27.4
Kolkata	3.4	34.2	28.2	Vijayawada	—	35.6	27.2
Kozhikode	6.4	28.2	24.8	Visakhapatnam	—	32.5	27.6

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad	..2	..39	..51	...118	...116		In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Khairthal,
Bengaluru	..22	..17	..41	...45	...103		Rajasthan recorded an
Chennai	..9	..15	..50	...112	...109		overall air quality index
Delhi	..31	..37	120	...180	...195		(AQI) score of 196
Hyderabad	..13	..23	..59	...28	...34		indicating a moderate
Kolkata	..5	..27	..42	...65	...94		level of pollution. In
Lucknow	..31	..32	..15	...35	...44		contrast, Aizawl, Mizoram
Mumbai	..5	..38	..39	...27	...59		recorded a healthy AQI
Pune	..11	..17	..71	...43	...106		score of 14
Visakhapatnam	..13	..62	..31	...74	...122		

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY

Visalam Mani
98 years
W/o KS Mani
Attained Shivalokaprapti on 26.08.2026
Deeply mourned by
KS Viswanathan (Kasi) & Vijaya Viswanathan
Meena Ramachandran
Bhuvana Venkataraman & U Venkataraman
Loving Grand Children and Great Grand Children.
PRANAVAM
Luz Church Road, 1st Cross Street, Mylapore, Chennai
9841049976 / 9444854320

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

In Loving Memory

M. L. Sampath Kumaran
DOB: 09.09.1931- DOD: 27.08.2025
You are missed each and every day for you were someone special who meant more than words can say. Remembered by Smt Chitra Sampath M. S. Vijay Sai, M. S. Giridhar

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES
To dedicate a space in this section, Please contact:
044-28576300
from 10.00 a.m. to 6.00 p.m.
Toll Free: 1800 102 4161
from 10.00 a.m. to 10.00 p.m.
For Placing Advertisements Online
log on to
www.thehinduads.com
DONATE EYES GIFT SIGHT

BIRTHDAY REMEMBRANCE

BIRTHDAY REMEMBRANCE

Mrs. Vilasini Hannah Bhaskar Rao
Rtd. HOD Quaid-E-Millath Govt. college for Women
Fondly remembered by Husband, Son & Daughter-in-law

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

EIGHTH ANNIVERSARY

Mrs. LEELA MARTHANDAM
D. O. B: 15-08-1946 D. O. E: 27-08-2018
" To the world You were a mother To our family You were the world! " Missing you deeply...

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

FIFTH ANNIVERSARY

SRI. V.S.A.RM. AN. RAMASAMY CHETTIAR KOTTAIYUR
22.02.1935 - 27.08.2021
Chairman & Managing Director Shyamala Pictures & Shyamala Studios, Chennai
"We love you and will miss your presence forever"
Fondly remembered by Sons, Daughters in law & Grandchildren

DEATH



It is with profound grief that we announce the passing of our mother, grandmother and great-grandmother,

Smt. Rukmani Ammal

wife of Late Shri Manikudi V Krishnamoorthy Iyer, Kumbakonam, who attained the lotus feet of the Lord on Wednesday, 26 August 2026.

A life of love, kindness, strength and devotion, her blessings and memory will forever remain in our hearts

In Loving Memory

Mr. MK Venkatraman
Mrs & Mr. K Kalyanaraman
Mrs Padma Srinivasan

Mrs & Mr. MK Rajagopalan
Mr. Srinivasan

Grandchildren and Great-Grandchildren



Drawing lines

India and China must be transparent about the talks on boundary dispute

Following Tuesday’s talks between the Special Representatives (SRs) on the boundary question, India and China have agreed to substantial outcomes on managing the disputed border. According to an eight-point consensus released on Wednesday, both countries have agreed to advance discussions on “an early and substantial harvest of boundary delimitation”. They have agreed to hold next month a meeting of an expert-level mechanism on trans-border rivers and to maintain communication on sharing hydrological data, which India has been pushing for. Two additional meeting points to hold talks between top military commanders will be set up, along with two new channels of hot-lines in the Eastern and Middle Sectors. National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and China’s Foreign Minister Wang Yi reaffirmed the efforts taken over the past two years to keep the peace along the Line of Actual Control, and committed to continuing the on-going normalisation in relations. That the NSA’s visit to Beijing took place before India hosts the BRICS Summit, on September 12, underlined both sides’ keenness to continue with this process of re-engagement, with the expected visit of Chinese President Xi Jinping after a gap of seven years. An October 2024 meeting between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Mr. Xi kick-started this calibrated effort towards normalcy, and a 2025 meeting in Tianjin helped continue the momentum. It is apparent that both sides see continued engagement at the highest level as key to sustaining this process of normalisation.

The dual tracks of the SR meetings and the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination on border affairs, a body comprising diplomats and military officials, have worked well towards keeping the borders generally stable over the past two years. The latest outcomes will certainly help in keeping the peace. Less clear is how both sides intend to take up the task of border delimitation. Neither side has explained which parts of the border they plan to delimit, or whether they are reconsidering the 2005 agreement on Political Parameters and Guiding Principles, under which the SRs were tasked with first agreeing a framework to settle the boundary. While both sides in Beijing reaffirmed the 2005 agreement, Article 10 of its text notes that it is only on the basis of the framework that both sides can delineate the boundary. Tangible progress on the border dispute must certainly be welcomed. However, agreements made without public visibility, notwithstanding their merit, may invite suspicion. As India and China continue negotiating their long-running boundary question, it is imperative that they bring their publics along.

Grounded

Chennai needs more runways, not just new terminals

The Tamilaga Vетtri Kazhagam (TVK)-led government, in dropping the ₹27,400-crore greenfield airport project at Parandur near Chennai, appears to have considered the opposition to the project without weighing the consequences. The decision follows an electoral promise made by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, who had visited the protesters in January 2025 to express his solidarity. The government says the move is aimed at protecting the interests of farmers and local residents. It has also cited the presence of waterbodies and has alleged commercial motives behind the site selection under the previous DMK government. Notwithstanding these official reasons, all valid to varying degrees, it became clear from the day Mr. Vijay became Chief Minister, on May 10, 2026, that the decision was merely a formality. In fact, much before the announcement, on August 24, work on the project had come to a halt. However, the move is likely to have adverse consequences for Tamil Nadu. The move risks creating a general perception that Tamil Nadu is unstable in its infrastructure policy, which the TVK government should have avoided, given its goal of making the State a \$1.5 trillion economy by 2036.

While Mr. Vijay has spoken of identifying a new airport site, his proposal for a Terminal 5 at the existing airport is necessary and welcome. However, it is common knowledge that a green-field airport will take years to materialise, even with unwavering government attention – the idea for a second airport had been under consideration for over 25 years. At one stage, the Union government had wanted it to be developed on a build, operate and transfer mode. Unfortunately, the project was caught in the game of political one-upmanship between the two Dravidian majors. Meanwhile, Bengaluru and Hyderabad have had new second airports since 2008, despite regime changes. Passenger traffic here has grown at Tamil Nadu’s expense – at an annual average rate of 10% during 2016-26 compared with 2.4% in Chennai. Parandur received the Union government’s final nod in July 2024, after much ground-work. When the State government is not the ultimate authority in airport site selection, it would not be appropriate to attribute motives to the DMK. Land for any mega project has always faced landowner resistance and the TVK regime may experience this while identifying a new site. No development project can take place without disturbing the environment and certain sections of society. Even Amsterdam’s busy Schiphol airport sits over an area that was once a lake. At the existing airport in Chennai, a runway was affected by the severe floods in 2015. What policymakers should bear in mind is the need to balance development and climate change challenges. Chennai needs more runways, not just new terminals.

For crores of Indian families, the financial shock of hospitalisation – especially in a private hospital – begins even before treatment is complete. The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Health and Family Welfare, in its 176th Report tabled in Parliament on August 7, 2026, noted that the average cost of hospitalisation is ₹50,508 in a private facility, compared with ₹6,631 in a government facility. For childbirth, the average out-of-pocket medical expenditure in private facilities is ₹37,630, against ₹2,299 in public facilities.

Some of the contradictions

The committee has made 368 recommendations, including standardised package rates and mandatory pre-treatment cost estimates. Among the widely reported proposals is that basic room tariffs in metropolitan private hospitals should not exceed the average tariff of three-star hotels that are nearby. It has also suggested that large corporate hospitals earning from medical tourism, foreign patients and high-net-worth individuals should cross-subsidise poorer Indians and reserve beds for Ayushman Bharat-Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY) beneficiaries at regulated rates. Yet, there is a contradiction. India wants more private and foreign capital in health care, particularly in Tier-2, Tier-3 and rural areas, while simultaneously asking the government to review foreign direct investment rules related to the acquisition and management of existing hospitals.

There is a strong case for continued investment in Indian health care. Hospitals require substantial capital. Land, equipment, intensive care units, digital systems, laboratories and trained personnel are expensive. Public hospitals cannot currently meet all demand for secondary and tertiary care. Private hospitals therefore fill an important gap. Foreign investors and private-equity funds can bring capital, managerial capacity, technology and the capacity to expand hospital networks. India also needs investment in pharmaceutical and medical-device manufacturing. If regulation becomes excessively restrictive or unpredictable, some investment may move elsewhere. This could slow capacity expansion and delay the development of better health-care infrastructure in cities and districts where need is genuine.

However, in all sectors, capital comes with expectations of returns. In health care, it creates a special concern because patients are not ordinary consumers. A patient rarely decides independently whether an MRI is required, whether hospital admission should continue for two more days, or whether a procedure is necessary. Health care is shaped by what



Chandrakant Lahariya

Practising physician specialising in preventive and cardio-metabolic medicine, whose upcoming book, ‘Pill-Free: You Don’t Need Everything You Have Been Prescribed’, will be released in September 2026

The country needs private capital to expand health care, but investment cannot be allowed to shape clinical decisions, pricing and access in ways that make care unaffordable or unnecessarily intensive

economists call information asymmetry: the provider knows more than the patient. Therefore, when financial incentives become too strong, they can influence not just the price of care but also how much care is delivered.

A closer look at private care

This is where the role of private equity and venture capital in health care deserves closer attention. Corporate hospital groups increasingly compete for well-known specialists, sophisticated technology and premium infrastructure. These can improve quality, but also create a high-cost ecosystem. Hospitals that pay very high salaries to senior specialists and super-specialists, acquire expensive equipment and operate under pressure to increase revenue must eventually recover these costs. Revenue targets, procedure-linked incentives, higher occupancy expectations and higher revenue per bed can gradually influence institutional behaviour. Most doctors act in patients’ interests. Yet, systems shape behaviour. If hospitals and doctors are rewarded for doing more, the direction becomes predictable.

The result is not only higher cost but also a worrying medicalisation. Lab investigations may detect abnormalities that would never have caused harm. More screening can lead to unnecessary follow-up tests. A patient who could be managed as an outpatient may be admitted. Caesarean sections, angioplasties, intensive-care admissions, diagnostic packages and long lists of medicines must therefore be seen not only as individual clinical decisions but also within the incentive structure of the health system. This does not mean these interventions are usually unnecessary. It means that a system rewarding interventions and procedures needs strong safeguards against unnecessary prescriptions, surgeries, investigations and medications.

That is why a review of FDI in the acquisition of existing hospitals is justified. Domestic investors can be equally profit-oriented, while foreign investment can create valuable capacity. The more useful question is about what an investment does to the health system. Does it create new beds or simply acquire existing ones? Does it improve competition or lead to market concentration? Does it enter an underserved district or add another high-end facility in a metro? If an investor receives concessional land, tax benefits or other public support, are there enforceable obligations related to affordable beds or participation in public insurance schemes? India should encourage greenfield investment and manufacturing, while scrutinising acquisitions that reduce competition or raise the risk of excessive pricing.

Price regulation also needs to be approached carefully. The proposal to link hospital room charges to nearby three-star hotels is easy to

understand, but cannot by itself solve the affordability problem. A hospital room includes nursing, infection-control and emergency support that a hotel room does not. More importantly, if one component of the bill is capped, hospitals may increase charges elsewhere. India’s experience with coronary stent price regulation showed that government intervention can reduce excessive mark-ups. But hospital care is more complex; what matters is the total cost of an episode. Package rates, transparent estimates, billing standards and audit mechanisms are therefore more useful than isolated caps on individual components. There is also an established approach to such payments: Diagnosis-Related Groups (DRG). A DRG is a patient-classification system that standardised hospital reimbursement by paying a fixed, predetermined amount for an inpatient stay based on the diagnosis and procedures, rather than reimbursing each service separately.

Focus on public health

There is a larger policy question. India cannot regulate its way out of weak public health care. If government hospitals remain overcrowded, understaffed or difficult to access, citizens will continue to depend heavily on private providers. Experience from OECD countries has shown that one effective form of regulation is a strong public health system that provides a credible alternative.

Public hospitals must therefore become a genuine option, not merely the last resort for those who cannot afford private care. Primary health care needs strengthening so that disease is prevented, detected and treated early. Insurance systems, including AB-PMJAY, should reward appropriate care rather than simply higher volumes of procedures. Clinical audits, evidence-based treatment protocols and transparent billing can protect both patients and doctors from commercial pressures.

The Parliamentary Committee is right to focus attention on affordability and to question whether the current pattern of investment in private health care aligns with public interest. Price caps and an FDI review are reasonable starting points, but India needs a wider conversation about the kind of health-care system it is building. Private investment will remain essential, and profit by itself is not the problem.

The problem begins when the pursuit of returns starts a key influence. A health-care system should attract capital, but its clinical priorities must still be set by medical need. The true measure of India’s health-care progress will not be how much money flows into hospitals or what is the annual compounded growth rate in medical tourism, but whether Indian citizens can enter them with confidence that they will receive what they need. No more, no less.

Making India’s food system climate-proof cannot wait

India’s food security journey is undoubtedly one of the most significant agricultural transformations in the world. From dependence on food aid in the 1960s, the country has emerged as a major food producer, built substantial buffer stocks, and created a legal entitlement to subsidise foodgrains for around 800 million people through the National Food Security Act (NFSA), 2013. This achievement rests on decades of public investment in improved seeds, irrigation, procurement, storage, price support and public distribution. The task now is to protect and strengthen that achievement amid a changing climate and increasingly frequent extreme weather events.

Climate change threatens food security globally. For India, the policy challenge has evolved beyond producing enough food to ensuring affordable, nutritious supply for 1.4 billion people despite rising temperatures, erratic rainfall, extreme weather, and water scarcity affecting production, storage, transport, and consumption.

The advantages

India has the initial advantage to address this challenge. Foodgrain production reached more than 350 million tonnes in 2024-25, including record output of rice and wheat. The Public Distribution System (PDS), supported by digitisation and the One Nation One Ration Card (ONORC), has expanded the reach and portability of food entitlements. These foundations provide the production capacity and administrative depth and expertise needed to support the transition towards a climate-resilient food-security framework.

India’s evolving food-systems approach recognises that climate risks span the entire value chain. Heat reduces wheat yields, erratic monsoons cause floods and droughts within seasons, groundwater depletion weakens irrigation buffers, and extreme weather damages storage and transport infrastructure. These cascading effects create market volatility and limit household access to nutritious foods.



Elisabeth Faure

Country Director, UN World Food Programme in India



Purvi Mehta

International expert on nutrition-sensitive agriculture, food systems and climate-resilient development

India has built food security; now it must climate-proof it for a secure food future

The rice-wheat system has served India well, but national procurement remains concentrated in a few crops and geographies. Several of these areas also face serious groundwater stress. This model emerged as a rational response to the production constraints of an earlier era. The opportunity now is to build on its achievements by progressively diversifying procurement across crops and regions, while making the system more responsive to climate and natural-resource considerations. The procurement may gradually expand across geographies and commodities, with price support aligned to encourage crops suited to local water and climate conditions. Millets, pulses, oilseeds and other nutri-cereals can reduce risk concentration while strengthening dietary diversity. Cereals such as rice and wheat will remain essential, but a broader procurement base can create a more resilient national portfolio.

Along with the procurement, the PDS can progressively reinforce a diversified food basket. A carefully designed inclusion of locally appropriate millets and pulses would strengthen the connect between food security with nutrition, water conservation and climate adaptation.

On climate information

Forecasts from the India Meteorological Department may be linked more directly with procurement, buffer-stock and contingency decisions. The NFSA’s monitoring framework can also include indicators for heat, water stress, storage exposure and supply-chain resilience, alongside coverage and offtake. Farmers require practical tools for managing risk. Climate-resilient seed varieties, micro-irrigation, watershed development, precision farming, digital advisories and weather-indexed insurance may reduce variability and support better decisions. Public-private collaboration would also help accelerate research, certification and last-mile delivery, while public safety nets can ensure that smallholders and climate-exposed regions are not left behind.

drain water, but captures, conserves and puts it to productive use. The installation of scientifically designed honeycomb sponge manholes along roads across the country could become an important component of such a national water-management

strategy. Honeycomb sponge manholes can be designed to receive and temporarily store rainwater, allowing it to percolate into the ground in a controlled manner and contribute to groundwater recharge. This system could function as a decentralised rainwater-harvesting

network beneath our streets. India should consider pilot projects in cities that regularly experience severe urban flooding.

Richard Hay, Kochi, Kerala

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Deletions in recent SIRs suggest arbitrary application of reasons

Extremities in deletions

Chances on life on Mars

Entrance into the Army

Centre plans integrated command centres to step up border security

The 'smart border' architecture will integrate AI, sensors, surveillance systems and unified command-and-control centres, says official; focus on addressing threat from drones used for smuggling; pilot project to start soon from Pakistan border

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The Union Home Ministry is developing a technology-driven command-and-control system for India's land borders that will integrate surveillance inputs from the field through a network of command centres stretching from forward areas to New Delhi, according to a senior government official.

The initiative, part of a new border management policy, is aimed at strengthening monitoring and response capabilities in border regions where physical fencing is not feasible, such as the 3,488-km border with China, which remains un-demarcated at several points from Ladakh to Arunachal Pradesh. A pilot project will start soon from the Pakistan border, the official added.

Home Minister Amit Shah had earlier announced a four-pronged border security strategy,



The initiative is aimed at strengthening response capabilities in border areas where physical fencing is not feasible. REUTERS

Border-management tech will be tailored to local conditions rather than deployed uniformly

which involves border guarding forces, local population, State police and technological solutions.

"There will be several small command centres along the land borders that will be linked to the field

headquarters and further to Delhi headquarters. The live feed will help the border guarding forces to monitor and also save the resources, reducing the need for physical patrolling," said the official.

Faster responses
The "smart border" architecture for all of India's land frontiers would integrate artificial intelligence, sensors, surveillance systems and unified com-

mand-and-control centres to strengthen border security and enable faster responses to threats, the official said. India shares 15,106.7 km land border with seven countries.

"The proposed framework is designed to bring together surveillance inputs from multiple technologies, including cameras, sensors, image-processing tools, drones and other monitoring systems, to create a common operational picture for agencies deployed along India's borders," said the official.

The system was envisaged as an integrated platform where information gathered on the ground could be transmitted quickly to command-and-control centres, allowing authorities to respond more effectively to infiltration attempts, smuggling networks and other security challenges, said the official.

Addressing the growing

threat from drones, particularly for smuggling and reconnaissance, has emerged as a major focus area, particularly along the Pakistan border.

Localised deployment
According to the official, border-management technologies would be tailored to local conditions rather than deployed uniformly. India's land borders traverse deserts, mountains, riverine stretches, forests and densely populated areas, requiring customised solutions for different terrains and operational requirements, the official added.

"No two borders are the same. Just like the China border, which cannot be fenced, there are riverine stretches along the Bangladesh border, which are flood-prone. No fence can be put there. We are moving towards a concept where physical presence is not always required," said the official.

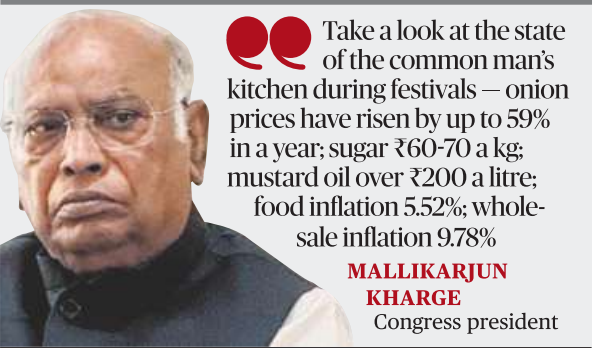
'Achche din' promised by BJP has wrecked common man's budget, says Kharge

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on Wednesday targeted the Narendra Modi government over the rising prices of essential commodities, saying the "achche din" (good times) promised by the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) had instead left the common person's household budget battered by food inflation.

In a post on X, Mr. Kharge said the BJP was attempting to evade accountability through "distracting stunts and nonsensical talk", but the Congress and the public would continue to raise questions over inflation.

"Take a look at the state of the common man's kitchen during festivals — onion prices have risen by up to 59% in a year, ₹50-₹60 a kg in many cities; sugar ₹60-70 a kg, up to ₹72 a kg in some places; mustard oil over ₹200 a litre; food inflation 5.52%; wholesale inflation 9.78%," Mr. Kharge said.



Take a look at the state of the common man's kitchen during festivals — onion prices have risen by up to 59% in a year; sugar ₹60-70 a kg; mustard oil over ₹200 a litre; food inflation 5.52%; wholesale inflation 9.78%

MALLIKARJUN KHARGE
Congress president

He said that after 12 years of BJP rule, "sometimes lentils, sometimes vegetables, sometimes oil, sometimes sugar" continued to put pressure on household budgets.

The Congress chief cited a comparison of retail prices in May 2013 and August 2026, based on figures attributed to the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation and newspaper reports.

The comparison showed steep increases across several kitchen staples. Tomatoes recorded the sharpest rise, from ₹17.50 a kg in May 2013 to ₹120 now — an increase of

585.71%. Onion prices rose from ₹23 to ₹73 a kg, or 217.39%, while atta increased from ₹21 to ₹69 a kg, a rise of 228.57%.

Mustard oil rose from ₹102 to ₹263 a kg, while groundnut oil increased from ₹165 to ₹286. Milk prices rose from ₹36 to ₹85 a litre.

'Over 100% rise'
The Congress said prices of several essential commodities had thus increased by more than 100% over the period. The comparison comes amid the party's continuing attack on the government over inflation and the cost of living.

LS Secretariat issues notices to 20 MPs who switched from Trinamool to NCPI

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Lok Sabha Secretariat on Tuesday issued notices to 20 MPs who had switched from the Trinamool Congress to the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI). The notices were issued more than a month after Trinamool national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee wrote to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla urging him to disqualify the legislators.

The development came on the same day that a Supreme Court Bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V. Mohana agreed to hear Mr. Banerjee's plea seeking an expeditious decision on the disqualification petitions.

Mr. Banerjee had filed disqualification petitions against the MPs on June 19 under Rule 6 of the Members of Lok Sabha (Disqualification on Ground of De-



Mahua Moitra

fection) Rules, 1985.

Mahua alleges cover-up
Reacting to the development, Trinamool MP Mahua Moitra alleged on X on Wednesday that there had been a cover-up regarding the timing of the notices issued by the Lok Sabha Secretariat. She pointed out that the party had filed 20 disqualification petitions on June 19 and then shared an image of the notice issued to the rebel MPs.

"Speaker LS did nothing except give them better seats at our expense. [Sol-

icitor General] SG Tushar Mehta in Court said the Speaker had issued notices. Notice dated Aug. 25th-exact date of hearing!" she wrote on X.

While issuing notice to the 20 rebel MPs, the Supreme Court declined to issue any notice to the offices of the Lok Sabha Speaker and the Secretary-General of the House after Mr. Mehta informed the court that he was representing them.

During the hearing, the court observed: "It is not a question of issuing notices; it is a question of concluding the proceedings within a time frame."

Mr. Banerjee had earlier submitted separate disqualification petitions against the 20 MPs and subsequently sought their expeditious disposal. He also met the Lok Sabha Speaker on August 12 about the issue, after sending a written reminder on July 27.

BJP accuses Rahul of hypocrisy over 'smash patriarchy' remark

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Wednesday accused Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and the Congress of hypocrisy over women's empowerment, citing what it described as inappropriate remarks by several Congress leaders.

At a press conference, BJP MP Bansuri Swaraj accused Mr. Gandhi of "misogyny" and referred to a recent Congress event.

"Ten days ago, Mr. Gandhi himself participated with Sandeep Dikshit in a very cheap joke targeting a woman Prime Minister, and that too the Prime Minister of our friendly country, Italy, Ms. Meloni. It was almost like you were over-hearing boys talking in a local room....," she said, alleging that Mr. Gandhi's "smash the patriarchy" remarks in Pune were an attempt to divert attention from the controversy.

"You want to smash the



Bansuri Swaraj

patriarchy? I am very comfortable singing Christmas carols on Christmas, singing *Vande Mataram* in its entirety, and reciting the *Shiv Tandav*. I challenge you: If you want to actually smash the patriarchy, then sing *Vande Mataram* in its entirety...." Ms. Swaraj said.

She said that had Mr. Gandhi truly wanted to act on women's empowerment, he would not have strongly opposed the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam.

She asked why there was no woman Minister in the Karnataka and Himachal Pradesh Cabinets.

Need Kargil-style review of Operation Sindoor after ex-CDS's remarks: Ramesh

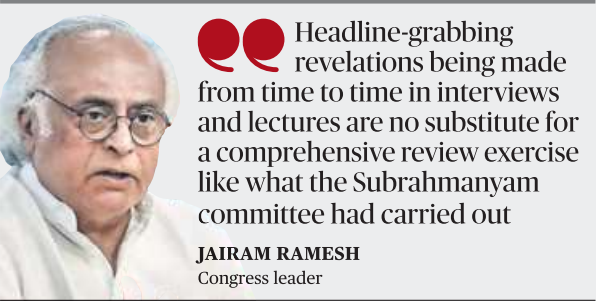
Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

A day after former Chief of Defence Staff General Anil Chauhan (ret'd) made fresh remarks on Operation Sindoor, Congress leader Jairam Ramesh on Wednesday called for a comprehensive official review of the military operation on the lines of the Kargil Review Committee.

Mr. Ramesh, Congress general secretary (communications), said Gen. Chauhan's latest remarks, coupled with his earlier revelations, had raised understandable concern and warranted a structured review of the operation.

Vital revelations

"In a media interview given in Singapore on May 30th, 2025, the-then Chief of Defence Staff Gen Anil Chauhan had made some very significant revelations on Operation Sindoor. Just yesterday Gen. Chauhan



Headline-grabbing revelations being made from time to time in interviews and lectures are no substitute for a comprehensive review exercise like what the Subrahmanyam committee had carried out

JAIRAM RAMESH
Congress leader

has again made some very important revelations that have raised understandable concern," Mr. Ramesh said in a post on X.

He recalled that four days after the Kargil War ended, the then Atal Bihari Vajpayee government had, on July 29, 1999, constituted the Kargil Review Committee under the chairmanship of top security analyst K. Subrahmanyam. The committee's report was tabled in Parliament on February 23, 2000.

"Headline-grabbing revelations being made from time to time in interviews and lectures, whether part

of a deliberate strategy or not, are no substitute for a structured and comprehensive review exercise like what the Subrahmanyam committee had carried out," Mr. Ramesh said.

The demand came after Gen. Chauhan, speaking at the 'VIMARSH' event on Operation Sindoor and its aftermath at the Vivekananda International Foundation on Tuesday, said a loitering munition deployed during the operation may have struck the Kirana Hills area near Sargodha in Pakistan, where nuclear-related facilities are located.

Bihar turning police into a 'weapon' to evade accountability, says Rahul

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, on Wednesday accused the Bharatiya Janata Party-led Bihar government of using the police to suppress student protests, instead of addressing allegations of irregularities in recruitment examinations.

The Congress leader's remarks came amid a controversy over a viral video of a six-year-old boy who was taken away by the police during a student protest in Patna.

Though social media posts claimed that the child had been "arrested" for participating in the protest, the police said he had been taken to the police station for his "own safety" and was later handed



Police deployment during a protest march by students demanding the cancellation of 70th BPSC examination in Patna on Tuesday. ANI

over to his mother.

In a post on the social media platform X, Mr. Gandhi said students in Bihar were asking simple questions — why were there irregularities in recruitment examinations, why has no action been taken on the allegations of paper leaks, and how long would the government continue to "tamper with the future" of the youth.

"The controversy over

BPSC (Bihar Public Service Commission) examinations is not new. Students have been protesting for a long time over the recruitment process, examination pattern, delays and transparency. But instead of answering, what is the government doing? It is using batons and water cannons and taking students into custody," he said.

Referring to an incident in Siwan earlier, Mr. Gand-

hi alleged that even an AK-47 rifle was used against protesters. "This is not merely a question of police action; it is a question of the mindset of the BJP government, which has no answers. That is why it is turning the police into a weapon to evade accountability," he said. The government should understand that "questions do not stop with batons", he said.

"You cannot snatch away someone's future by instilling fear. The students of Bihar will keep asking questions. And now, they demand accountability," he said. The remarks came a day after thousands of students clashed with the Bihar Police in Patna after being stopped from marching to the Chief Minister's residence.

(With inputs from PTI)

Cong. slams M.P. govt. for 'shielding' Minister over remarks against Colonel Sofia Qureshi

The Hindu Bureau
BHOPAL

The Madhya Pradesh Congress attacked the BJP government in the State on Wednesday over reports claiming that the Cabinet had refused to allow the prosecution of Minister Vijay Shah for his derogatory remarks against Army Colonel Sofia Qureshi last May, days after Operation Sindoor.

State Congress chief Jitu Patwari has written to President Droupadi Murmu, urging her to dismiss the State government for allegedly blocking the judicial process and shielding Mr. Shah from accountability.

"The government's decision not to grant sanction for prosecution against Vijay Shah, while also providing political protection, raises questions about the system in which the ruling party is standing as a wall in the way of the judicial process to shield its political figures from accountability. The government's stance raises a serious constitutional question: Are those in power above the law?" he wrote.

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited	
Regd. Office: PSEB head office, The Mall Patiala- 147001 Corporate Identity No. U40108PB2010SGC033813 Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 98461-01116)	
Tender Enquiry No. 38/GCD/LDH/TS/PSPC/L/2026	Dated: 27.08.2026
ASE/Grid Construction, opp. PAU Gate No.1, PSPCL, Ludhiana invites Short Term e-Tender for Outsourcing of 1 no. New 66 KV Substation Tapprian Khurd with 12.5 MVA PTF works on partial turnkey mode under Grid Construction Division, Ludhiana under Grid Construction Circle, Ludhiana. For detailed NIT & Tender Specifications please refer to http://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 27.08.2026, (01:00 PM onwards). Note: Corrigendum and amendments, if any, will be published online at http://eproc.punjab.gov.in .	
C 827/26	1079/12/2026-27/14612

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT				
Form of Contract : Lumpsum (TWO COVER SYSTEM) E-Tender Notice No.2 / TVM – CLE / 2026 – 2027 / Dated. 25 .08.2026.				
For and on behalf of Governor of Tamil Nadu E-Tenders are invited by the Superintending Engineer, PWD., Buildings (Construction and Maintenance) Circle, Tiruvannamalai-4, for the following work from the eligible Contractors registered in Public works Department of Government of Tamil Nadu, upto 3.00 pm as per server clock on 28.09.2026 under two cover system (Pre qualification and Price E-tender). The last date and time for submission of E-Tender Documents upto 3:00 pm as per Server Clock on 28.09.2026. The E-tender schedule can be downloaded at free of cost from the Govt designated web site (vz) https://tntenders.gov.in from 28.08.2026 to 28.09.2026 upto 3.00 PM and to be submitted through online only. The Prequalification cover (Cover I) alone will be opened on 28.09.2026 at 4.00 PM by the Superintending Engineer, PWD., Buildings (C&M) Circle, Tiruvannamalai-4, through online.				
Sl. No.	Name of Work	Approximate value of work including GST (Rs.In lakh)	Amount of Earnest Money Deposit (In Rupees)	Period of Completion (including monsoon period)
1.	Construction of 50 Bedded Critical Care Block in Government Medical College and Hospital Campus at Siruvangur in Kallakurichi District.	1945.20	Rs. 9,83,000/-	15 Months
Eligible Class of Contractor : Class -I and above.				
The Earnest Money Deposit should be paid only through online. The date and Time of opening of Price E-tender will be intimated to the Prequalified contractors through online. Further Details can be had from the above web site https://tntenders.gov.in Superintending Engineer, PWD., Buildings (C & M) Circle, Tiruvannamalai- 4. DIPR/2663/Tender/2026				

INBRIEF



Sonya Gill, AIDWA leader and PARI co-founder, passes away

Sonya Gill, women's rights activist and former Maharashtra Secretary of All India Democratic Women's Association (AIDWA), died in Mumbai on Tuesday after a prolonged illness. She was 70. She was the co-founder and trustee of the People's Archive of Rural India (PARI). She is survived by her husband and journalist P. Sainath, who was with her when she collapsed during evening walk on Tuesday. Her colleagues at PARI remembered her fondly for her courage and work ethic. "It is extremely shocking and distressing to know that our dearest comrade, Sonya Gill, is no more. It is unbelievable," said Mariam Dhawale, vice-president of AIDWA.

West Bengal govt. seeks report from hospital on infant deaths

The death of 10 infants at the Malda Medical College and Hospital in West Bengal on August 12 has sparked concern, with the West Bengal Health Department seeking a report on the deaths. West Bengal Health Minister Sharadwat Mukherjee confirmed the development, and said hospital authorities had been asked to submit a report. "The infant mortality rate has increased in Malda. We have asked for a report. We have asked for details on why it happened, what caused it," Dr. Mukherjee said. Prosenjit Bar, superintendent of Malda Medical College and Hospital, said that of the 10 infants who died in a single day, eight were born elsewhere and referred to the hospital, while two were born inside the hospital. According to sources, about 60 infants have died at the hospital in August.

Meghalaya to oppose mining of uranium

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The Meghalaya Assembly on Wednesday adopted a resolution opposing uranium mining and the establishment of any uranium ore-processing facility in the State.

Chief Minister Conrad K. Sangma moved the resolution in the 60-member House and said the government was on the same page as communities living in the uranium-bearing areas of the West Khasi Hills district.

The resolution referred to the Supreme Court's 2019 order in the State of Meghalaya versus the All Dimas Students' Union, which recognised the rights of private and community landowners over both the surface and the minerals beneath their land.

"Meghalaya is governed by a distinctive constitutional and customary framework under the Sixth Schedule of the Constitution, which protects community, clan, and individual ownership of land and resources," Mr. Sangma said. The resolution was intended to record Meghalaya's opposition to uranium extraction, he said. "We will communicate the decision of the House to the Centre," the Chief Minister added.

New LPG connections still on hold amid West Asia tensions

This is a 'temporary measure' due to the 'geopolitical situation', says the Petroleum Ministry; distributors are pushing the 5-kg free-trade cylinders and the 10-kg composites as alternatives

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Consumers across the country continue to wait for new cylinder connections of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) as supplies remain uncertain due to the episodic flare-ups in the West Asia conflict.

Distributors in New Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Bengaluru, and Chennai said they have not issued any new connections for the 14.2-kg cylinders meant for domestic consumers since mid-March.

The Hindu had earlier reported that applications seeking new LPG connections were still on hold, months after other curbs introduced at the peak of the West Asia crisis were lifted.

Temporary measure

In a social media response addressing the concern, the Union Petroleum Ministry's grievance redressal platform said, "Due to the prevailing geopolitical situation, issuance of new LPG connections is temporarily on hold. At present, distributors are prioritising refill supplies for existing consumers to ensure uninterrupted essential services."



Desperate measures: At present, distributors are prioritising refill supplies for existing consumers over new applications. ANI

It added that this was a "temporary measure", with new connections expected to resume once the "situation stabilises".

Pawan Soni, general secretary of the Federation of LPG Distributors of India (FLDI), told The Hindu that the supply situation is comfortable at present, although it is difficult to predict whether it will remain so over the longer term.

"Nobody knows how many ships carrying LPG [oil marketing companies] OMCs will be able to procure, as the situation in West Asia remains uncertain. Moreover, storage capacity will also have to be managed efficiently in line

with demand," he said.

According to Bijan Behari Biswas, vice-president of the West Bengal unit of the All-India LPG Distributors' Federation, there are an average of 100 to 120 applications for new connections pending with individual distributors across the State.

"However, what we have noticed is that most of these applicants prefer to wait for a new domestic connection instead of getting a free-trade LPG cylinder for a temporary period," he said.

Alternative options

Several distributors across the country have suggested that waiting consumers

India rejects rights abuses allegations of UN committee

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

India rejected a report issued by a UN body on Wednesday that alleged various ethnic and religious groups in the country faced discrimination.

The UN Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination flagged concerns over human rights violations against Scheduled Tribes, Scheduled Castes and Rohingya refugees. It also called for action against those involved in "hate crimes" in India.

External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said India rejects "any politically motivated highly malicious references in the report".

"During the review, we highlighted India's constitutional safeguards, robust legal framework, pluralism, and sustained efforts to protect disadvantaged communities. While we will respond to the committee's observations through the established procedure, the inter-ministerial delegation, which was led by the Solicitor General of India, Tushar Mehta, had already rejected the sweeping generalisations, unsubstantiated allegations, and the tendency to exceed the Convention's mandate during the meeting," he said.

Only 2,790 students enrolled against a target of 10,500 for govt.'s free coaching programme

Maitri Porecha
NEW DELHI

The Centre has not been able to effectively implement the scheme of providing free coaching to economically disadvantaged students appearing for competitive exams, a parliamentary Standing Committee report has noted.

Of the targeted 10,500 candidates to be enrolled for free coaching, the Union government could enrol only 2,790 students (26%) over the past three years.

In a report tabled in Parliament on August 10, the Standing Committee on Social Justice and Empowerment noted that the target fixed by the Ministry of Social Justice of annually extending free coaching to



For 2026-27, the target for the free coaching scheme is set at 7,000 beneficiaries.

3,500 students could not be achieved.

The road map of the "free online coaching" plan has not yet been made public.

Poor uptake

The report noted that while in 2023-24, only 223 students were given free

coaching, this service was extended to 2,136 students in 2024-25 and only 431 students could avail the benefits of free coaching in 2025-26.

The Standing Committee, in its report, noted that out of a budget estimate of ₹47 crore in 2023-24, actual expenditure towards the free coaching scheme was only ₹7.76 crore. Subsequently, the budget estimate was reduced to ₹35 crore in 2024-25 and the actual expenditure was ₹17.68 crore only, the report noted. While the committee has stated that in 2025-26, the budget estimate was further downgraded to ₹20 crore and the actual expenditure was only ₹7.11 crore. In its action-taken reply, the Ministry has stated that the actual expenditure during

2025-26 was ₹9.86 crore.

Union Public Service Commission (UPSC), Staff Selection Commission (SSC), and Railway Recruitment tests, entrance tests such as IIT-JEE and NEET, and eligibility exams such as SAT and GRE are among those covered for free coaching. The scheme covers free coaching for Scheduled Castes (SCs), Other Backward Classes (OBCs) and beneficiaries under PM CARES for Children Scheme.

In 2026-27, the Ministry of Social Justice has fixed a target of enrolling 7,000 candidates for free coaching.

The report notes: "The committee does not understand the reason for fixing a target of 7,000, which is double the previous target, particularly when the tar-

get fixed earlier has not been achieved."

'Revise income ceiling'

The Standing Committee report noted that one of the major hurdles preventing candidates from availing the scheme is fixing a ceiling of annual family income at ₹8 lakh.

The committee had recommended that the family income ceiling should be re-examined, so that a large number of candidates can avail the facility.

In its reply to the panel's observations, the Ministry of Social Justice said the target of 7,000 slots has been proposed to expand the reach of the scheme.

Empanelled Central universities select eligible SC and OBC students through their own screening process.

Police to bar CJP protest in Delhi ahead of BRICS meet

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Police will not allow the protest march called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on September 5 in New Delhi, nearly a week before the two-day BRICS leaders' summit, a senior officer said on Wednesday.

The CJP had announced on August 24 a "peaceful march" from India Gate to Delhi Police headquarters against the Centre's "failure" to honour the assurances that had prompted the group to end its 36-day agitation at Jantar Mantar on July 25.

On Wednesday, the All India Students' Association (AISA) offered support to the proposed 3-km march and demanded withdrawal of FIRs against student protesters and a probe into



All India Students' Association (AISA) offered support to the proposed 3-km march. ANI

allegations of police brutality at earlier protests.

AISA president Neha Bora said issues that triggered the agitation at Jantar Mantar remain unresolved.

Prohibitory orders

"Section 163 of the BNSS is currently in force in the New Delhi district, prohibiting processions, demonstrations and assembly of

five or more persons, except at designated protest sites," the officer said.

"So far, we have not received a request from the outfit. Even if we do, a protest march won't be allowed in New Delhi due to security concerns," said the officer, adding that they are likely to ask the organisers to seek permission for the event outside the New Delhi district.

The police have stepped up security for the international summit on September 12-13, which several dignitaries, including Russian President Vladimir Putin, are expected to attend. They are chalking out deployment and accommodation plans for the visitors and finalising routes for the movement of their vehicles while trying to minimise disruption to regular traffic.

THE CROSSWORD+14883

(Set by Dr. X)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

SCAN TO PLAY

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

14

18

21

24

25

26

27

Down

1

2

3

4

6

7

8

9/12

15

16

17

19

20

22

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

21

22

23

24

25

26

27

1

5

10

India improvising on the fly as Strait of Hormuz waters remain still

NEWS ANALYSIS
M. Kalyanaraman
CHENNAI

Iran and Oman officials and ministers continue to meet to come up with a framework to administer the Strait of Hormuz so traffic can restart. The two countries seem to have buried their differences that cropped up end of June when Iran vehemently opposed an additional route hugging Oman's coast that would allow ship transit. But Washington has been unwilling to give Iran much leverage on the strait, leave alone let Iran charge a toll. So, six months after the war began, the strait remains practically closed. With little strategic stor-

age, India has been improvising on the fly, managing to keep things going. A gamechanger would be if China starts competing for Russian oil in a big way with India. Saudi Arabia and the UAE have sought land-route alternatives to Yanbu and Fujairah ports, but only for crude oil, not for petroleum products, LPG or LNG. Some 5 million barrels, roughly a third of pre-war crude flows, are still moving out of the region, though Houthi attacks have cut that by nearly 1 million barrels on some days. Some high-risk shippers still operate vessels including LNG and LPG carriers across the Strait for a premium, often slipping through at night with elec-

tronic identification switched off. Average Strait of Hormuz flows now stand at close to 0.25 million barrels a day, against 15 million before the war, estimates Pankaj Srivastava, SVP at Rystad Energy. China has so far largely sidestepped the crisis through deep strategic reserves, pipeline alternatives, and a pivot to electric vehicles and renewables. India, with minimal strategic petroleum reserves and almost no strategic gas reserves, has instead scrambled to build alternative supplies — chiefly Russian crude and U.S. LPG — while leaning on demand destruction and refinery expansion, even as it continues occasional Hormuz transits.



Chinese checkers: A gamechanger would be if China starts competing for Russian oil in a big way with India. REUTERS

“India’s strategic oil storage of 5.33 million tonnes will last just nine days, but commercial stocks at refineries can provide a cushion of a month or slightly more,” Mr. Srivastava says. India has walked a deli-

cate line: leveraging ties with Iran for ship transit, working with Oman and UAE to keep supplies flowing, and avoiding antagonising the U.S. ADNOC LNG ships have continued docking in India through the

war, though the Iranian attack on Al Reyayyat in early July acted as a dampener. Prashant Vasisht, SVP at ICRA, says China, until now more reliant on its own strategic reserves, has now started chasing Russian oil and competing with India for it. “What is providing some cushion for Brent is the IEA’s 400-million-barrel strategic reserve release, of which some 290 million have already been consumed,” he says, warning of the consequences of its depletion. In the war’s early days, India had some 22 Indian-flagged vessels in the Gulf, along with many ships carrying energy cargo bound for the country. As of last week, six Indian-flagged

and eight foreign-flagged vessels of Indian interest remained west of the strait, carrying 171 Indian seafarers. **Vessel movement** Some 63 India-bound cargo vessels have transited the strait since the war began, against an estimated 950-1,000 vessels that have left the strait overall, per Lloyd’s List. Of the 63, 24 were Indian-flagged and 39 foreign-flagged: 29 bulk carriers, many carrying fertilisers or fertiliser inputs, 14 LPG carriers, 12 crude carriers, two LNG carriers and so on. Eight fertiliser-carrying ships for India remain west of the strait, still awaited. India’s LPG delivery runs on a just-in-time sys-

tem built around Indian tonnage sufficient for the four-to-seven-day Gulf voyage. As India pivots to the U.S. — Kpler estimates America supplied some 60% of India’s LPG imports in May — ships have been rerouted accordingly. India lacks enough vessels to be self-reliant on the six-week U.S. route, forcing it to buy relentlessly from other carriers even while pushing domestic production 30% above pre-war levels. Longer voyages, higher prices, and freight inflation have taken their toll: LPG under-recoveries per cylinder have tripled for oil companies, with a modest price hike doing little to help. “Barmer refinery starting up is a welcome relief,” adds Mr. Srivastava.

Gross FDI hit 15-year high of \$30.7 billion in April-June 2026

An analysis of latest RBI data shows net FDI turned positive again in June 2026, with inflows exceeding outflows by \$1.3 billion that month

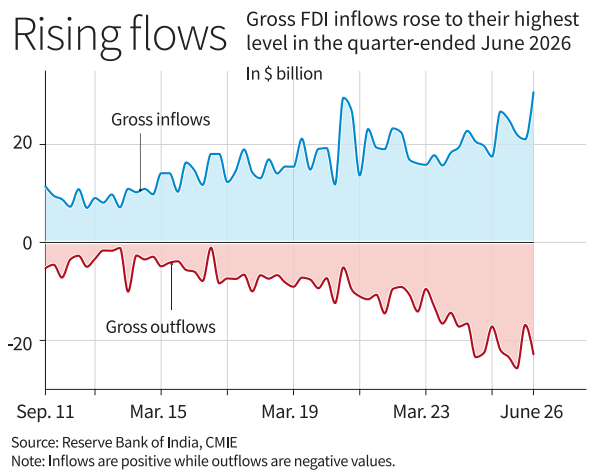
T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

India attracted a total of \$30.7 billion as gross foreign direct investment in the April-June 2026 quarter, the highest level in at least 15 years. This strong inward flow overshadowed outflows, resulting in net FDI in the quarter rising to its highest level since June 2022.

An analysis of the latest data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) shows that net FDI turned positive again in June 2026, with inflows exceeding outflows by \$1.3 billion that month, driven by an increase in investment entering the country and a fall in outward investment by Indian companies.

A longer-term analysis also shows that inflows are starting to outpace outflows on a more regular basis. For instance, while net FDI was negative in six out of the last 12 months, it was negative in only one of the last six months.

Strong inflows Gross inflows in June 2026, or the total amount of direct investment that entered the country that month, stood at \$9.3 billion. This was 53% higher than in May, but just a little lower than the \$9.6 billion that entered the country in



June last year. According to the RBI, Singapore, the Netherlands, the U.S., and Canada accounted for around 74% of the inflows. The manufacturing sector received the highest share of inflows, followed by electricity generation, computer, and communication services.

On a quarterly basis, gross inflows stood at \$30.7 billion in April-June 2026, which was nearly 46% higher than in the quarter ended March 2026 and about 15% higher than June 2025 quarter.

This was also the highest inflow recorded in the accessible data, which goes back 60 quarters or 15 years to the September 2011 quarter. According to the RBI, this underscores the “continued interest of

global investors in India”. Total outflows of direct investment stood at \$7.9 billion in June 2026, which was nearly 30% higher than in May, and 8.6% higher than in June of last year. On a quarterly basis, total outflows stood at \$22.8 billion. As a result, net FDI stood at \$1.3 billion in June 2026 and \$7.8 billion in the April-June 2026 quarter. Within outflows, repatriation and disinvestment by foreign companies operating in India grew to \$5.8 billion in June 2026, 57% higher than in May, and 36% higher than in June last year. Outward FDI by Indian firms, on the other hand, fell to \$2.1 billion during this period, down 13% over May 2026 and 30% lower than in June 2025.

JSW Group in talks with SAIC of China to increase stake in JV

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

The Sajjan Jindal-led JSW Group is in talks with China’s SAIC Motor to increase its stake in their joint venture, JSW MG Motor India, as the group looks to expand its presence in the Indian automobile sector. “We are talking to them, so it’s between shareholders right now. Again, I won’t comment on how much because it’s all under discussion at this stage,” JSW MG Motor India Director Parth Jindal told journalists in Mumbai on Wednesday.

According to reports, JSW Group is seeking to increase its stake in the joint venture by about 10%. JSW currently holds 35%, while SAIC Motor owns 49%. The remaining stake is held by Indian institutional investors, employees of JSW MG Motor India and the company’s dealers.

Apart from JSW MG Motor India, the group is setting up a separate automobile company, JSW Motor Ltd., which will focus on manufacturing electric vehicles. JSW Group is also in discussions with Skoda Auto Volkswagen India for a potential acquisition of a majority stake.

If the proposed transactions materialise, JSW Group would emerge as a significant player in India’s automotive industry, with investments across three entities and a portfolio spanning multiple brands.

Retail sugar prices stabilise, likely to see drop in coming days

The Hindu Bureau
COIMBATORE

Retail sugar prices in most of the markets across the country continued to hover between ₹65 and ₹70 a kg with a section of traders expecting the prices to drop in the coming days.

In Uttar Pradesh, which is one of the main sugar producing States, retail sugar prices ranged between ₹50 and ₹65 per kg in the midst of fears in the market of shortage. “The price has risen by over ₹10 in the last 15 days,” said Vikas Gautam, a customer based in Lucknow.

In Mumbai, the prices were ₹77-80 a kg. However, bulk buyers said they had adequate stocks. In Hyderabad, some of the outlets have restricted the quantity that can be purchased.

In Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu, the retail price is ₹69-70 a kg, while restaurant and sweet and savoury outlets were getting sugar from wholesale dealers at ₹67-70 a kg.

“We have a six-month contract with our supplier. He is asking for a revision of the contract now as the prices are increasing,” said



In Uttar Pradesh, retail sugar prices ranged between ₹50 and ₹65 per kg.

one of the large-scale restaurant owners in Coimbatore.

According to C. Dorairaj, president of the Indian Chamber of Commerce and Industry, Coimbatore, retail prices have stabilised in the last couple of days and some of the wholesale markets have seen a slight drop in prices too.

The Uttar Pradesh government has intensified action against hoarding and said there is no shortage in availability of sugar.

According to Vishal Nirani, MD of Nirani Sugars, Karnataka expected sugar production of 6.5 million tonnes in the current season. Due to erratic climatic conditions, the actual production is 5.7 MT.

IN BRIEF



ICAT issues first compliance certificate for multi-axle bus

The International Centre for Automotive Technology (ICAT) has issued its first compliance certificate for a 15-metre multi-axle sleeper bus, marking a significant step in the certification of longer and more complex passenger vehicles for India’s inter-city transport sector. The certificate has been awarded to Synaty Automotive Pvt. Ltd.’s bus, certified under AIS-119 and AIS-153 in accordance with the applicable provisions of the Central Motor Vehicles Rules. The certification comes amid heightened scrutiny of sleeper bus safety following series of fatal fires and accidents.

JSW Group puts battery plant on hold over tech constraints

The JSW Group has put its proposed battery manufacturing plant in Odisha on hold as it continues to look for a technology partner for lithium iron phosphate (LFP) battery cells, Parth Jindal, Director of JSW MG Motor India and Managing Director of JSW Cement and JSW Paints, said on Wednesday. “We are very keen to make cells in India. But the LFP technology currently is not available for us. The hunt is on for a technology tie-up. We have not yet secured a technology tie-up, and hence, that project currently is on hold,” Mr. Jindal said in Mumbai.

PARADIP PORT AUTHORITY
e-TENDER CALL NOTICE
No. EM/WS-D/TECH-04/2025/1314,
Date: 20.08.2026
e-TCN No. EM/WS-23/2026
Name of the work : "Hiring of 01 no. new Truck Mounted Conveyorised Mechanical Road Sweeping Machine for cleaning of roads inside Port area for a period of 05 (03+02) years".
Estimated Cost : Rs.6,34,80,000/- excluding GST and cost of Diesel.
Last Date & time of submission of bid : dt.12.09.2026 up to 1800 Hrs.
Refer our website for details : <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>.
Executive Engineer (M),
Workshop Division-II, Paradip Port Authority
PPA/PR/2026-2027, dt.26/08/2026

Jaysingpur Municipal Council, Jaysingpur (M.S.)
Municipal Office, Jaysingpur
E-Tender Notice 2026
JNP/C.D/E-Tender Notice/1641/2026 Date - 25/08/2026
Jaysingpur Municipal Council invites E-Tender for construction of roads & civil work at Jaysingpur for Jaysingpur Municipal Council, Jaysingpur, Tal - Shirol, Dist - Kolhapur, State - Maharashtra. For more details kindly visit <http://mahatenders.gov.in> from Date - 27/08/2026, 11.00 A.M. upto Date 03/09/2026, 4.00 P.M.
Sd/- Chief Officer, Jaysingpur Municipal Council
Sd/- President, Jaysingpur Municipal Council

SRM E-Tender Notice (4th Call)
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Company Ltd, EHV PC O&M Zone Vashi invites bids through SRM e-Tender in two bid system (Techno-commercial Bid & Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for following works;

RFx No./ Tender No.	Particulars	Estimated Cost
7000041331	Work of EHV Bays strengthening for capacity enhancement of: i) 220kV Navi Mumbai PG I & II Line bays, 2Nos of TBC bays & Auxiliary bus at 220kV Apta substation ii) 220kV PG & Panchanand Line Bays, 1No of TBC Bay and Auxiliary bus at 220kV Talaja Substation iii) 220kV Cable replacement work of 220kV Talaja & Kalwa Line Bays at 220kV Panchanand substation under EHV (O&M) Division Panvel	Rs. 1540.76 Lakhs excl. GST Rs. 1818.10 Lakhs incl. GST

E.M.D. in Rs 15,40,767/-, Tender Fees: Rs 29,500/- including GST, Sale period: 26.08.2026 to 07.09.2026, Last Date of Submission: 07.09.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs, Date of opening (Tech. bid): 07.09.2026 at 15:30 Hrs(if possible), Contact person: Executive Engineer, EHV PC O&M Zone, Vashi, Phone No. (022) 27666010 (P) / 27665994. For further details please visit to <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
Note: The pre-bid meeting scheduled on 01.09.2026 @ 13:00 Hrs at MSETCL Zone Vashi
Chief Engineer, EHV PC (O&M), Zone, MSETCL, Vashi

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD
INVITATION FOR TENDER
(Only Through KPP Portal)
BWSSB invites Tenders in Two Stage Tender System from registered Contractors for the following works.
Office of the Engineer in Chief, 2nd Floor, Cauvery Bhavana, KG Road, Bengaluru- 560 009.

Sl No.	Name of the Works	Amount put to Tender
No:BWSSB/EIC/ACE(CS&DCW)/2723/2026-27		Dated:25.08.2026
1.	Estimate for the work of O&M & Upgradation & repair of D2A of Bulk Flow meters coming under AEE(UFW) sub division. (2nd Call)	₹ 397.51 Lakhs ₹ 5.96 Lakhs
No:BWSSB/EIC/ACE(CS&DCW)/2727/2026-27		Dated:25.08.2026
2.	Estimate for the work of O&M & Upgradation & repair of D2B of Bulk Flow meters coming under AEE(UFW) sub division. (2nd Call)	₹ 397.63 Lakhs ₹ 5.96 Lakhs
No:BWSSB/EIC/ACE(CS&DCW)/2725/2026-27		Dated:25.08.2026
3.	Estimate for the work of O&M of Stage 1,2,3 network flow meters coming under AEE(UFW) sub division. (2nd Call)	₹ 399.63 Lakhs ₹ 5.99 Lakhs
No:BWSSB/EIC/ACE(CS&DCW)/TA/2729/2026-27		Dated:25.08.2026
4.	Work of Modernization & Remodeling of Water Supply System and reduction in UFW in Bank Colony area of Hanumanathnagar DMA of existing DMA of existing SW3DMA09 DMA coming under AEESW-3 sub division limit of BWSSB, Bengaluru	₹ 382.46 Lakhs ₹ 6.76 Lakhs

For all the above works Last date and time for Receipt of tenders is on 10.09.2026 upto 16:00 hours. The bids will be opened on 11.09.2026 at 16:30 hours.
Sd/- Engineer-in-Chief
The details regarding participation in the e-procurement portal process can be obtained by logging on to <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> For further details contact the above signed office during working hours.
DIPR/CP/2430/CCL/2026-27

Karnataka Power Transmission Corporation Limited
(CIN : U40109KA1999SGC025521)
BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION
(THROUGH KARNATAKA PUBLIC PROCUREMENT PORTAL ONLY)
No. CEE/T&P/SEE-1/2/2026-27/5471-94 Date: 24.08.2026
KPTCL invites Bids on electronic mode for the following works against following enquiry numbers on Partial Turnkey Basis.

Sl. No.	Enquiry Nos. and Name of the works
1	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4086 Establishing 2X20MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at Neralekere in Magadi Taluk, Bengaluru South District with construction of associated 66kV Transmission line and Terminal Bays for a distance of 6.806kms.
2	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4088 Establishing 2X20MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at Hunasekatte village in Bhadravathi Taluk, Shivamogga District with construction of associated 66kV 630sqmm UG Cable L.I.L.O for a distance of 0.597kms and Overhead Transmission line for a distance of 0.811kms.
3	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4094 Establishing 2x20MVA, 110/11kV sub-station at Navage in Belagavi Taluk & District by constructing 110kV L.I.L.O Line from existing 110kV Belagavi (220kV)-Mache line to proposed 110/11kV Navage sub-station for a distance of 3.52kms using 110kV 630sqmm UG cable.

The bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only. The details regarding participation in the e-tendering process can be obtained by logging on to KPTCL website: <https://kptcl.karnataka.gov.in> with hyperlink "E Procurement KPTCL" or <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> on or after 03.09.2026 @ 15:00hrs. Last date & time for receipt of Bids and any extension of Due date for Bid submission will be intimated in the KPP Portal. Any details required in this regard can also be had from the office of the undersigned during office hours.
All Corrigendum/Addendums shall be noticed by the bidders before the last date of submission of the Bids.
Sd/- Chief Engineer (Electy.),
Tendering & Procurement, 9th Floor, Indhana Bhavan,
KPTCL, A.R. Circle, Bengaluru – 560 009.

CM
YK

Bahutule effusive in praise of debutant Saransh's efforts



Dinusha pleased with first innings hundred, wants to score more



Starc replaces Bumrah as the top-ranked bowler in Tests



Federer celebrated upon his return to the US Open



Sooriyabandara and Kamindu shine as Sri Lanka lives to fight another day

Abid spins North into the semifinals

Svitolina-Monfils pair on a good run; Serena and Alcaraz out

A CH-CHE

INBRIEF



Chotrani, Senthilkumar in Budapest squash quarters

Veer Chotrani, *in pic*, and Velavan Senthilkumar advanced to the quarterfinals of the Budapest Open, a \$43,500 PSA copper event. Chotrani, the third seed, beat Rui Soares of Portugal 13-11, 12-14, 11-9, 12-10 in the pre-quarterfinals following a first-round bye in the new season. Senthilkumar, the eighth seed, defeated German fifth seed Raphael Kandra 11-9, 6-11, 11-7, 11-2 in the pre-quarterfinals after putting it past Briton Will Salter 11-9, 11-6, 11-5 in the opening round.



Andrews named asst. coach of U-17 women's football team

The All India Football Federation has appointed Anthony Andrews as the U17 women's national team's assistant coach under head coach Joakim Alexandersson. Andrews, who also serves as head coach of East Bengal FC, will take up the role on a dual basis with the club and country.

India names squad for AFC U-20 Asian Cup Qualifiers

India on Wednesday named a 23-member squad for AFC U-20 Asian Cup Qualifiers in Tashkent. The qualifying tournament will be held in the Uzbek capital from August 31 to September 6 and the main tournament will be held in China next year. The Blue Colts will face Syria on Aug. 31, Uzbekistan on Sept. 3 and Bangladesh on Sept. 6. The group winners and the seven best runners-up across all eight groups will qualify for AFC U-20 Asian Cup China 2027.

The squad: Goalkeepers: Jaskaran Dub, Pranav Sundarraman, Suraj Singh Aheibam.
Defenders: Asher Rebello, Bungson Singh Takhellambam, Karish Soram, Malemngamba Singh Thokchom, Sumit Sharma Brahmacharimayum, Vaipharemba Chingakhram.
Midfielders: Aniket Yadav, Danny Meitei Laishram, Md. Arbash, Rishi Singh Ningthoukhongjam, Rishikanta Meitei Laishram, Samson Ahongshangbam, Shami Singamayum.
Forwards: Daniyal Makakmayum, Gunleiba Wangkheirakpam, Hateem Ali, Omang Dodum, Prashan Jajo, Rothen Singh Chaphamayum, Vishal Yadav.

AROUND THE CITY

Sunshine Chennai, St. John's in final
Sunshine Chennai SSS beat Jeppiaar School by seven wickets while St. John's Public School thrashed St. Patrick's by nine wickets in the XL1 Super Sports u-12 inter-school cricket semifinals at the Wahe Guru-B ground.
The scores (semifinals): Jeppiaar School 181/5 in 30 overs (Prajesh Mahendran 64, S. Arya 48) lost to Sunshine Chennai SSS 182/3 in 30 overs (L. Sai Praneet 77 n.o., L. Krish Sanjith 46). St. Patrick's 37 in 17.1 overs lost to St. John's PS 39/1 in 4.1 overs.

State-level children's chess
Jaigopal Garodia Memorial Chess Academy-Tamil Nadu State-level children's (u-7, 9, 11, 13 and 17 boys and girls) chess tournament will be held on September 20 the at Smt. Durgadevi Choudhary Vivekanaanda Vidyalaya SSS, Sakthivel Nagar, Kolathur, Chennai. Entries close on September 18. Email: jgvsvsn@gmail.com. Ph: 26711820 / 26710543.

ENGAGEMENTS

General: 52nd Seethakathi State-level tournament, A.M. Mohammed Ismail, Entrepreneur, inaugurates (9 a.m.); A. Chandrasekaran, former Assistant Director, Enforcement Directorate, gives away the prizes (2.30 p.m.), Crescent School, Vandalur.

LIVE TELECAST

Sri Lanka vs India: Second Test, Day 5, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 9.45 a.m.
Hockey World Cup (Women): Star Sports First & JioHotstar, 1 p.m. 2.30, 4, 5.30, India vs Germany, 6.30 p.m. 8.30, 9.30 p.m. & 12 a.m. (Friday)
England vs Pakistan: Second Test, Day 1, Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 3.30 p.m.
US Open: SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 8.30 p.m. & 4.30 a.m. (Friday)
LaLiga: FanCode, 12.30 a.m. (Friday).

Lokeshwar and Deeban sizzle as Kovai Kings storm into the final

The opener's half-century and his 104-run alliance with partner Radhakrishnan power the team to 183 for five; Grand Cholas' chase derailed by the pacer's hat-trick; left-arm spinner Siddharth wreaks havoc with a four-for



The dazzlers: Lokeshwar laid the platform for Kovai Kings with a knock of 66 before Siddharth and Deeban blew away Grand Cholas' batting line-up. R. RAGU



TNPL
S. Prasanna Venkatesan
CHENNAI

Lokeshwar had his fifty (66, 44b, 8x4, 1x6). Shahrukh Khan had his fireworks (18-ball 34). Deeban Lingesh had his hat-trick (three for 14). Siddharth had his four wickets (four for 11).
Trichy Grand Cholas, meanwhile, had a tragedy in four acts, as two-time champion Vida Kovai Kings stormed into the TNPL-10 final with an 84-

run win in Qualifier 2 at the M.A. Chidambaram Stadium here on Wednesday.
Kovai Kings will face Madurai Panthers in the summit clash on Friday.
The Kovai side's 183 for five was built on a 104-run opening partnership between S. Lokeshwar and S. Radhakrishnan (48), both of whom were given reprieves.
Early reprieve
Lokeshwar was dropped on seven and Radhakrishnan on 26, while the Grand Cholas later conceded another boundary through

a misfield.
Radhakrishnan went after pacer P. Saravana Kumar, while Lokeshwar repeatedly used his feet against the spinners and reached his seventh TNPL fifty from 29 balls.
Medium-pacer R. Rajkumar's three wickets (three for 29), along with a sharp catch in the deep, prevented the innings from getting completely away, but skipper Shahrukh Khan's late assault ensured his team finished strongly.
The Tiruchi outfit's chase was derailed immediately.

Medium-pacer K. Deeban Lingesh struck with a hat-trick off the first three balls – K. Rajkumar edging behind, S. Shyam Sundar edging to slip, and J. Kousik bowled – before completing the opening over as a maiden.
In disarray
Left-arm spinner M. Siddharth then had Sanjay Yadav (1) caught behind and Jafar Jamal bowled through the gate with an arm-ball in successive deliveries in the fourth over.
At seven for five after 21 balls, Grand Cholas had

gone from chasing 184 to a fight for survival. There was no way back.
Siddharth later removed R. Rajkumar (7) and Antony Dhas (6) to finish with the best bowling figures of the season.
The scores:
Vida Kovai Kings 183/5 in 20 overs (S. Radhakrishnan 48, S. Lokeshwar 66, Shahrukh Khan 34, R. Rajkumar 3/29) bt Trichy Grand Cholas 99 in 15.4 overs (J. Suresh Kumar 48, K. Deeban Lingesh 3/14, M. Siddharth 4/11, R. Divakar (Impact Player) 2/14).
Friday's match (final):
Madurai Panthers vs. Vida Kovai Kings, 7.30 p.m.

India has the wherewithal to come up trumps in women's T20 Asia Cup: Raman

S. Dipak Ragav
CHENNAI

As India looks to regain the women's T20 Asia Cup, former head coach W.V. Raman backed the Harmanpreet Kaur-led side to triumph in the continental event that starts in the UAE on Friday.
India had a disappointing campaign in the ICC T20 World Cup earlier this year, crashing out in the group stage.
"I think that will spur them on to try and regain the Asia Cup because they are smarting from a performance that was unexpected given the squad and the expectations that everybo-



Raman. FILE PHOTO

dy had," said Raman.
"I think this is a tournament that they will win because they have the wherewithal.
"This will also be a chance for them to start preparations for the next

T20 World Cup."
On the squad, the former India opener reckoned that the batting looks slightly weak compared to the World Cup squad in the absence of Jemimah Rodrigues.
"Maybe they could have thought of bringing in a couple of new medium-pacers, but that hasn't happened.
"They've gone in heavily with spinners. You have Bharti Fulmali coming back, and she's yet to prove her credentials, even though she's got the reputation of being a big hitter of a cricket ball," he added.
While India won the ODI World Cup last year,

the team has been inconsistent in T20Is, and the 61-year-old felt that it hasn't clicked as a unit.
"I have felt that Deepti Sharma has to deliver more as a batter because she's got the ability. She does that in other leagues across the world.
"Also, maybe Harmanpreet can bat at No. 3. If she can get more time, it will help her pace her innings better. It's just a question of them succeeding as a unit. I think that's what has not, perhaps, happened," said Raman.
(Watch Women's Asia Cup 2026 live on Sony Sports Ten 1 SD & HD and Sony LIV).

Total Chess World Championship Tour muscles its way into the calendar

P.K. Ajith Kumar

The chess calendar is crowded. Top players rarely get to take a breather these days with so many big events, across formats, taking place across the globe. And it is going to get even more crowded with the newly launched Total Chess World Championship Tour.
Its pilot will be held at Budapest from November 10 to 21. Lined up for the event are many of the biggest names in chess, headlined by World No. 1 Magnus Carlsen.
There are three Indians in the fray – Arjun Erigaisi and the Chennai siblings R. Praggnanandhaa and R. Vaishali. Arjun is one of the eight players from the



Ready for it: Pragg and Arjun will headline the Indian challenge in the newly launched tournament. FILE PHOTO

top-10 who will compete in Budapest.
The presence of men like Fabiano Caruana (World No. 2), Vincent Keymer (No. 5) and Wesley So (No. 6) ensures it would be a stiffly contested event, which will feature 24 players in all.

The first full tour will begin next year with four legs to be played in cities across the world. Conceived by Norway Chess, with blessings of the world governing body FIDE, the new tour combines different formats – classical, rapid and blitz. There are, of course,

separate World championships for all those categories, and the classical format Total World Chess Championship is not quite classical in fact: the time control is 45 minutes with an increment of 30 seconds per move.
That may look more rapid than classical, for which the time control is usually 90 minutes for the first 40 moves and then 30 minutes for the rest of the game with increment.
Total Chess, to be fair, isn't calling its format classical, but fast classical. That makes sense. For, classical chess needs to retain its prime place. The Total Chess Championship Tour, though, is a welcome addition. The more the merrier.

India will win gold at Asian Games: Neha



Big lessons: Sunelita believes the World Cup experience will stand her in good stead. AFP

HOCKEY
Aashin Prasad
AMSTELVEEN

Sunelita Toppo had a sleepless night after India narrowly crashed out of the World Cup. A goalless draw against Australia in Pool E of the second round pushed India to the third spot and its semifinal dream came crashing.
"We came so close and worked so hard to come here, but we couldn't achieve it. I know we finished the match in a draw, but our thinking was that we have to reach the semifinals," Sunelita, one of the youngest members of the team, playing her maiden World Cup, told *the Hindu*.
For senior midfielder Neha, participating in her third World Cup, the result brought back painful memories of previous setbacks – loss in the bronze medal game at 2020 Olympics and defeat to Australia in the 2022 Commonwealth Games semifinal.
"The same thing happened here... everyone was very sad, crying and concerned that we had come so close and missed an [opportunity to fight for a] medal. It's very difficult,

but the team is coming out of it," said Neha, as the team targets a rare fifth place finish in the classification game against Germany here on Thursday.
"Everyone is saying that we have created history [finish in the top six]. But a medal is a medal, so that sadness will always be there."
Sunelita, 19, believes the high-level tournament experience will stand her in good stead.
"I got a lot of learning points. There is not much pressure in a normal tournament. But in the World Cup, there was a lot of pressure. They [seniors] helped me to cope with it, which I will be able to use in the future," said the midfielder.
Neha hailed the current crop, calling it 'the best combination'.
If India beats Germany, it will be able to ride the momentum into the Asian Games next month, where the team is chasing its first gold in 48 years. "I think we will carry this team to the Asian Games. We will try to give our best. But we have to win the gold medal. No matter what happens, we will give our best. We will win the gold medal," said Neha.



Babar. AP

England eyes series sweep, Babar boost for Pakistan

Agence France-Presse
LONDON

England will aim to put its latest drinking drama behind it when it faces Pakistan in the second Test at Lord's starting on Thursday.
Root spent much of a pre-match press conference talking about Brydon Carse, dropped from the squad and now under investigation by the Cricket Regulator after videos on social media showed the fast bowler being led away by police in handcuffs following an incident at a Derby nightclub on Saturday.
England, with seamers Ollie Robinson and Josh Tongue taking eight wickets apiece, skittled out Pakistan for just 171 and 135 in the first Test while posting 409 itself, even though none of its four batsmen reached fifty.
By contrast, Pakistan was deficient in all departments with its inadequate batting compounded by an inaccurate and largely unthreatening pace attack.
Pakistan captain Babar Azam said he is "90% fit" as he returns to lead his country in the second Test against England.

Norris paints Dutch GP papaya orange in Zandvoort’s F1 swansong

While fans hoped for a Verstappen special to close out the Dutch GP’s six-year run on the F1 calendar, it was the reigning World champion who shone in one of the best drives of his career; the Red Bull driver crashed out on the opening lap in his final home race

R.K. Arjun

The dunes have never seen anything like it. For five years, Zandvoort’s banked corners and towering grandstands turned orange every August as hundreds of thousands of fans willed Max Verstappen to another home win. This time, the party was supposed to be a farewell. Instead, Zandvoort said goodbye to Formula 1 the way it said hello: with chaos, rain, a home hero in the wall, and a Brit lifting the trophy.

By the time the chequered flag fell on Sunday, August 23, Lando Norris had claimed his second consecutive victory, and denied an entire nation the ending it had scripted in its head.

Zandvoort’s farewell weekend didn’t wait until Sunday to get interesting. The Sprint format’s return brought two extra sessions of jeopardy. The paddock had already been buzzing before any engines were fired up as Verstappen’s future was dominating headlines after news broke of his new Red Bull deal, giving the weekend an added layer of sentiment before a single lap counted.

George Russell set the early tone, taking Sprint Qualifying pole ahead of Norris, while his Mercedes teammate Andrea Kimi Antonelli admitted to a mistake in that session that left his Mercedes battling floor damage. When the Sprint itself got underway on Saturday, it was Russell who converted pole into victory, but the story of the race belonged to Charles Leclerc, who produced one of the strongest drives of the weekend to scythe past Norris late on and finish second. It was an early hint that Ferrari, so often undone by a lack of raw pace on low-downforce, straight-heavy tracks, might have found genuine race-day speed on the twisting, banked layout on the coast of the Netherlands.

Slender margin

Saturday afternoon’s qualifying session for the Grand Prix itself was tighter still. As the first spots of rain began to fall, drivers scrambled back onto the circuit earlier than planned for their final runs. Antonelli briefly grabbed provisional pole before the reigning World champion snatched it back, and Russell then split the pair, finishing just over a tenth off the McLaren. Remarkably, only four hundredths of a second covered second, third and fourth on the timesheet. The width of a coat of paint separated the two Mercedes and Oscar Piastri.

Ferrari’s pair rounded out row three, unable to match the ultimate pace despite their evident race-day potential. Verstappen and Liam Lawson lined up on row four for Red Bull.

It was Norris’s second consecutive pole of the season and the 18th of his career and, tellingly, history was on his side. Every Dutch GP winner since Formula 1 returned to Zandvoort in 2021 had started from the front of the grid. Overtaking here is notoriously difficult; track position, everyone knew, would be everything.

If Zandvoort wanted a dramatic send-off, the weather obliged. Saturday’s track action had been run in the dry, but as Sunday approached, heavy rain swept in over the dunes. Drivers heading out for their reconnaissance laps found the circuit properly wet, some running through standing water, Lawson even sliding briefly through the gravel en route to the grid.

Then, as quickly as it had arrived, the deluge eased. With roughly 25 minutes to lights-out, the rain stopped, and just enough of the surface dried for every driver to gamble on slicks – albeit with damp patches still lurking in places. The FIA, wary of the conditions, sent the field around behind the Safety Car for the formation lap to assess grip before committing to a standing start, with the top four all rolling out on medium tyres.

Clean getaway

Norris made a clean getaway from pole, but it was Antonelli who produced the launch of the race, sweeping past Russell into second at Turn 1 while Ferrari’s starboy jumped Oscar Piastri off the line. Behind them, the two Red Bulls, Verstappen and Lawson, went wheel to wheel in a fight that felt, for a fleeting moment, like the Zandvoort of old.

Then it went wrong. On the sport’s biggest stage, on the day his home fans needed him most, Verstappen clipped the white line on the pit straight, lost the rear of his Red Bull, and speared into the wall at high speed. Debris scattered across the track. The red flags came out barely a lap into the final Dutch Grand Prix. Verstappen, shaken but unhurt,



GETTY IMAGES



confirmed over the radio that he was okay, a small mercy for a crowd that had gone silent in an instant. Amid the chaos, Gabriel Bortoleto also spun through 360 degrees but somehow kept going, dropping to 18th while teammate Nico Hulkenberg swerved clear.

With the order reset to the end of Lap 1, the race resumed as a standing start, delayed further when Ollie Bearman’s Haas stopped on the way to the grid. When the lights finally went out again, Antonelli was imperious, sweeping past Norris to seize the lead. At the same time, Piastri pulled off a similarly bold move on Russell for third – dropping the Mercedes man straight into Leclerc’s crosshairs.

Mid-race chess match

What followed was a mid-race chess match. Antonelli eked his advantage over Norris out to over a second, denying the McLaren driver the use of his overtake-assist mode, while behind them Leclerc hunted down Russell and eventually got the move done. Norris, meanwhile, was blunt about his tyres over the radio: “I’m pace zero – I’ve got nothing else.” It didn’t sound like a man about to win.

As the first round of stops unfolded, hard tyres became the tool of choice, with slow stops for both Piastri and Antonelli costing crucial tenths. Hamilton, canny as ever, stayed

out and inherited the lead, telling his engineer his tyres were “still okay” even as the pressure built. He eventually pitted on Lap 26, rejoining sixth.

The midfield had its own soap opera. A Gasly lock-up let Lindblad through, Hulkenberg picked off both, and Tsunoda muscled past the former in a scrappy multi-car scrap that would repeat itself in various forms all afternoon.

By the race’s halfway point, Antonelli still led the pack and Ferrari’s frustration was bubbling. Ordered to let Hamilton by, the Monegasque initially ignored the call before conceding a lap later, prompting a sarcastic radio message from his teammate: “Great waste of time there, guys.”

This is where the afternoon turned. Norris, seemingly out of answers a few laps earlier, found his rhythm again, chipping away at Antonelli’s lead. A second round of stops on Lap 48 briefly dropped him to third, over five seconds off the lead but with a seven-lap tyre offset. However, within three laps that gap was down to 1.4 seconds. By Lap 52, the Brit was all over Antonelli, who in his last race as a teenager pushed himself to his limits to keep the reigning world champion behind.

It didn’t matter, however, as Norris swept around the outside into Turn 1 to reclaim the lead and, moments later, picked off Hamilton too, completing a stunning double move that had the McLaren pit wall on its feet. A Virtual Safety Car, triggered by Esteban Ocon’s stricken Haas, briefly reshuffled the

field as several cars dived for fresh soft tyres. When racing resumed with ten laps to go, Norris led Russell by 6.8 seconds, with Antonelli a further 5.6 seconds back after taking a cheap pit stop to go to the soft tyres.

Grandstand finish

With Antonelli closing on his own teammate, Mercedes made the call: Russell, unimpressed but compliant, let his younger teammate through on Lap 65, grumbling that the team may have “lost a double podium.” Hamilton had used the opportunity to close right onto Russell’s gearbox, setting up a grandstand finish for the final spot on the podium.

The chaos wasn’t quite finished. With three laps remaining, a coming-together between the two Williams of Carlos Sainz and Alex Albon triggered a second Virtual Safety Car, handing Russell a brief reprieve from Hamilton’s chase. Sainz was later penalised 10 seconds for causing the collision.

Out front, none of it touched Norris. He crossed the line 11.536 seconds clear of Antonelli to seal his second win in a row, with Russell just holding off Hamilton by a fraction of a second for third, and Leclerc completing the top five half a second further back.

“Amazing. A tough race,” Norris said afterwards. “Probably one of my better wins; we had to fight for it well, but the pace was strong... Nice to win the final race here in Zandvoort”

As Formula 1 fans look back on the last five years at this incredible circuit, a few moments immediately come to mind. It began in 2021, the fairytale return to the calendar after 36 years of exile, with their very own Flying Dutchman speeding past Valtteri Bottas to hand the Netherlands a home winner on its first weekend back on the F1 map. Verstappen followed up his win in 2021 with two more victories, each one turning the dunes into a sea of orange smoke, and each one cementing Zandvoort’s reputation as the most partisan crowd in the sport.

There was 2024, when Norris ended Verstappen’s unbeaten home record and, on crossing the line, borrowed his rival’s own catchphrase over team radio: “Simply lovely, huh?” a cheeky nod that became one of the season’s most talked-about moments.

Last year, it was yet again McLaren which crossed the chequered flag first; however, they had an Australian at the helm this time. Piastri delivered a complete masterclass that weekend – pole position, every lap led, fastest lap of the race – sealing his first career Grand Slam in the process.

Thank you, Zandvoort. For five years of orange smoke and banked corners, for turning a farewell tour into one last classic, and for never once making it easy right up to the final lap. Formula One will be back on many circuits in the years to come, but few will be missed quite like this one.

THE GIST

▼

The Sprint format’s return brought two extra sessions of jeopardy, and the paddock had already been buzzing before any engines were fired up, Verstappen’s future was dominating headlines after news broke of his new Red Bull deal, giving the weekend an added layer of sentiment before a single lap counted

▼

Norris, seemingly out of answers a few laps earlier, found his rhythm again, chipping away at Antonelli’s lead. A second round of stops on Lap 48 briefly dropped him to third, over five seconds off the lead. However, within three laps that gap was down to 1.4 seconds. By Lap 52, the Brit was all over Antonelli

▼

As Formula 1 fans look back on the last five years at the incredible Zandvoort circuit, a few moments immediately come to mind. It began in 2021, the fairytale return to the calendar after 36 years of exile

Why India’s R&D system needs a map of where funds really go

India does not have a system that can tell funders, researchers, or the public details like who is being funded, by whom, for what, and whether that funding has already been given elsewhere; while the NITI Aayog has proposed a unified streamlining system, it still fails to address a key problem

Moumita Koley

A recent report by the NITI Aayog, about ‘Ease of Doing R&D in India’ revealed some uncomfortable truths about the research and development ecosystem in the country. Together with a companion survey with inputs from more than 400 institutional leaders and 850 scientists, the report said that close to 80% of funding under the Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF) – the flagship research funding body – is concentrated in the IITs. This is despite the ANRF’s mandate to support a wider base of universities and research bodies than the traditional funding model has managed.

There are also concerns that multiple Central agencies are possibly funding similar research areas, resulting in overlap and what the report calls “inefficient” use of public money.

These findings point to a common underlying gap: India does not have a system that can tell funders, researchers, or the public who is being funded, by whom, for what, and whether that funding has already been given elsewhere.

The NITI Aayog’s response to this gap is the Unified Project Management System (UPMS) – a system to streamline the planning, funding, monitoring, and evaluation of public R&D projects across Ministries and Departments.

This proposed solution sounds good; however, it does not directly address an important problem.

PIDs and metadata

The technical term for what is missing is ‘PIDs and metadata infrastructure’. In plain language, it means every research grant in India will need a permanent, unique, machine-readable identifier called a persistent digital identifier (PID). This is like how a PAN number identifies a taxpayer or an IMEI number identifies a mobile phone.

Each PID should then be attached to a standard set of details called the metadata: which agency gave the money, to which institution, to which named researcher, what amount, over what period, and in which field. Finally, there is a linking system that will allow officials to track these details using the PID.

So every time a scientist publishes a paper and includes the PID in it, the system can track and evaluate the outcome of public funding. At least this is the idea.

Right now, a lot of this information exists within Indian funding agencies – but it is scattered across dozens of separate agency databases, in inconsistent formats, and often as free text rather than structured data. A researcher’s name might appear one way in a Department of Science and Technology (DST) record and slightly differently in a Council for Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) database – and this difference can be enough for an automated system to not tell that they are the same person. An institution might be listed as “IISc, Bangalore” in one dataset and “Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru” in another, leading to a similar problem.



Currently, information about the use of public funding for research lies scattered across dozens of separate agency databases, in inconsistent formats, and often as free text rather than structured data. Representative image. TALHA HASSAN/UNSPLASH

Multiply such inconsistencies across thousands of grants a year and one can see that the result is an information that does not provide a reliable picture of how research funding is being used.

Other countries’ solutions

This is not a new problem and India does not have to solve it from scratch. A global, non-profit infrastructure setup called the Grant Linking System already exists to do exactly this. It was built by the open digital infrastructure organisation Crossref. Its registry is called ‘Research Organisation Registry’ (ROR), built by a different organisation.

The system works through a small number of PIDs, each solving one piece of the puzzle. First, a funder ID identifies the funding agency in detail – the division, department, and even ministry if required. A similar ROR ID identifies the institution receiving the funding. Finally, an ‘ORCID’ identifier – familiar to Indian researchers today since most scientific journals today ask for it – identifies the individual researcher, so that funding data can be aggregated per person.

Since 2020, Crossref has also extended its system to include a grant DOI: a permanent identifier for the grant itself, which can be linked to whatever comes out of it – papers, patents, data.

Taken together, these four identifiers plus the metadata allow a funder or an independent analyst to ask questions that are nearly impossible to answer in India today. For example, how many different agencies have funded near-identical proposals? Which fields are receiving disproportionate investments relative to the national priorities? Does a small number of institutions or researchers account for a large share of the total

funding? This is why many research funders have adopted this system, with more than 2 lakh grants registered on it worldwide. The scale of the underlying problem this system solves is also well-documented. One 2013 analysis of U.S. funders used automated text-matching software to scan several lakh federal grant applications and estimated that duplicate or substantially overlapping funding may have cost the U.S. nearly \$70 million. In a more recent analysis, in 2020, analysts checked nearly 20,000 competitive grants in Denmark and found that funds were getting concentrated among a small group of individual researchers and a narrow set of research topics.

This is similar to the pattern the NITI Aayog report flagged for Indian funding agencies – and painstakingly so.

Two ways forward

Polymakers considering how to act on NITI Aayog’s findings face two broad options. One is to build an entirely new, India-specific system from the ground up – a sovereign national grant registry, developed and maintained independently. This has the appeal of full control: India will own the infrastructure outright and could tailor it precisely to its own agencies and federal structure, including State research schemes that a global system might not naturally prioritise. The second option is to plug into the existing global non-profit infrastructure, requiring India’s funding agencies to become members of – and consistently deposit data with – the Crossref ecosystem that many research funders already use worldwide. This can be implemented faster since the technical standards and governance already exist,

and are maintained by an international community rather than by a single Indian agency operating alone. It would also make India’s publicly funded research immediately visible and comparable within the same global dataset used to study research funding everywhere.

There is also a practical middle path: using the technical infrastructure of PID generators and funders’ own governance structure. Specifically, we can learn from systems that have worked elsewhere, such as the U.K. ‘Gateway to Research’ portal and the European Union’s Community Research and Development Information Service (CORDIS) and Open Access Infrastructure for Research in Europe (OpenAIRE). They run their own government-owned portals as the single point of entry for funding agencies, and the portals generate identifiers fully compatible with the global Crossref/ROR/ORCID standards.

This gives national governments political ownership and the ability to require all domestic agencies to comply – while also ensuring that the resulting data speaks the same language as the rest of the world’s research infrastructure.

For India, this hybrid model would mean a single national portal – one that the NITI Aayog has already proposed, called UPMS, and which Central and State funding agencies must use. The UPMS system can internally mint Crossref-compatible grant DOIs and link every record to ROR and ORCID identifiers. Then, it will be much easier to check for duplicate records, fund concentration, and so on.

(Moumita Koley is a senior research analyst at the Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru. moumitakoley@iisc.ac.in)



For centuries, the Arctic cold has kept plant life small, with the extreme environment giving researchers a unique perspective. AFP

Arctic ‘jungles’ offer critical insights into climate studies

Associated Press

With no tall trees reaching to the sky, Alaska’s North Slope tundra can look desolate – especially to outsiders who are used to in-your-face greenery.

But up close, “the tundra’s kind of like the jungle,” says Adam Bloom, a Florida Atlantic University plant biology student. Except this lush Arctic jungle tops out at about 25 centimeters.

For centuries, the Arctic cold has kept plant life small, a sort of dollhouse of the earth’s miniatures. The extreme environment has long given researchers a unique perspective on what makes plants grow, insight that would be hard to obtain elsewhere. Now it offers them one of the world’s most useful windows on how climate change affects plant life, with the Arctic warming four times faster than the rest of the earth, especially in the winter. For example, researchers at the Toolik Field Station, 320 kilometers north of the Arctic Circle, are studying whether plants facing these harsh conditions evolve to compete or cooperate with one another.

Studies show that the colder and further north in the Arctic, the smaller the plant life. There are several reasons, but the main one is that life is rough in the winter. Anything that protrudes above the shallow, insulating snow cover is more prone to being damaged by the cold and wind or eaten by wildlife, says plant ecologist Anne Bjorkman of the University of Gothenburg in Sweden. Plus the frozen permafrost does not allow roots to grow too deep, she adds.

But the cold is weakening and the miniatures are stretching. This part of Alaska is about 2.7 degrees Celsius warmer than it was 40 years ago mostly because of the burning of coal, oil, and gas. “Plants that are already there are growing taller,” Ms. Bjorkman says, adding that they are likely to grow even taller in the future. And they are getting greener. Some of the long-term studies here are “trying to understand what controls how much plants grow, what controls how green it is,” and how all that is changing, says Columbia University ecologist Duncan Menge.

Meanwhile, taller plants that previously could not survive the cold are moving in, Ms. Bjorkman says. This process, called shrubification, can accelerate warming because of how the plants trap heat, says University of Colorado plant ecologist Sarah Elmendorf. Canopies of the taller, darker shrubs stick out of the snow and absorb more energy from the sun than the blanket of white snow, which reflects heat back.

“It is certainly a major fingerprint of change that we can see,” she says.

Darker tundra absorbing more radiation is “one of the main reasons for what we call arctic amplification, which causes climate change to accelerate” especially in the Arctic, says Mr. Menge.

The shrubs also trap more snow. That snow warms the ground below and allows microbes during the winter to release more of the heat-trapping gas methane, Ms. Elmendorf notes. The added greenery from the taller plants and shrubs could compensate somewhat by absorbing more carbon dioxide.

Expanding stands of willows seem to be providing more shade to streams and changing the ecology of fish, insects and birds, according to Chris Neill and Linda Deegan of the Woodwell Climate Research Center. They are conducting a multiyear study to see if an ecosystem adapts and even genetically evolves to handle the stress of climate change. If that is happening, it offers hope for the survival of some of the most fragile Arctic ecosystems, Ms. Deegan said.

Amid the stresses of the Arctic, scientists are rethinking the idea that all life is a cutthroat competition with winners and losers. It might be more about mutualism, with plant species cooperating so that everybody survives, says Jake Francis, a professor at the Florida Atlantic University.

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

167 years since the world’s first commercially successful oil well...

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1

The U.S. businessman _____ drilled the world’s first commercial oil well in Pennsylvania in 1859. While the oil was barely deep by today’s standards, at just under 70 feet, it proved that oil didn’t have to be collected only from the surface. The drill sparked the country’s oil boom and the world’s energy transformation. Fill in the blanks.

QUESTION 2

Most oil wells yield _____ along with crude oil. For many decades, operators would simply flare this substance off or burn it as waste, since it had no commercial value. But today, companies worldwide capture and use this byproduct carefully, both to reduce emissions and for its applications in producing electricity. Fill in the blanks.

QUESTION 3

Operators sometimes use hydraulic

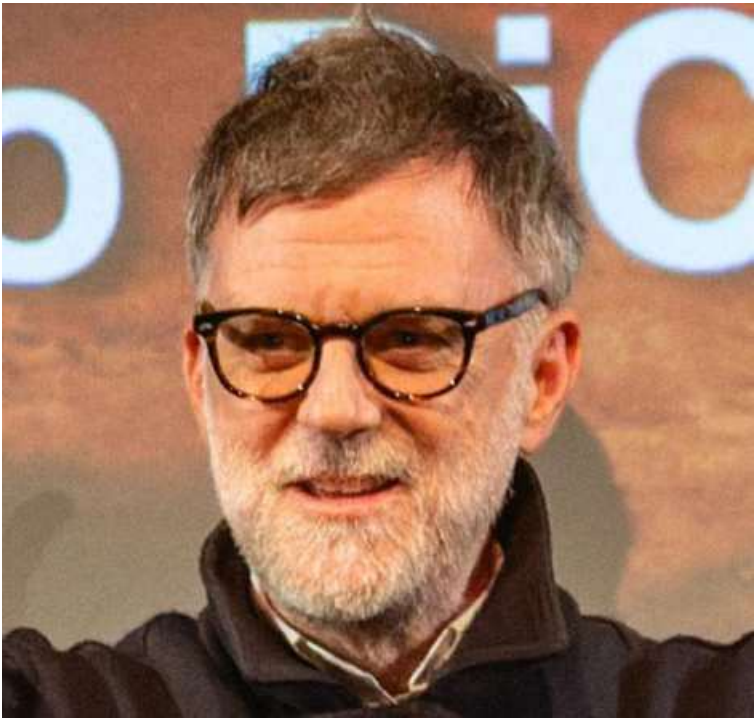
fracturing fluid under high pressure to crack rock formations – and contrary to popular perception, this fluid is typically more than 99% X and Y. The remaining fraction includes chemical additives to reduce friction and corrosion and to limit the growth of bacteria. Name X and Y.

QUESTION 4

In the early years of drilling for oil, uncontrolled gushing of oil from wells was a common sight, and often deadly too. Engineers subsequently prevented large valve systems that could seal wells off when the pressure within surged, considerably improving safety. What are these systems called?

QUESTION #5

The _____ is a common sight in oil fields, with its rhythmically bobbing motion earning it the affectionate monickers “nodding donkey” and “grasshopper”. These machines mechanically lift oil from wells where the natural pressure is too low. Fill in the blanks.



Visual: Who is this man and what is his public connection with oil wells? RAPH_PH

Answers to August 25 quiz:

1. What Galileo argued in 1618 were optical illusions – **Ans: Comets**
2. Planet that Galileo had mistaken for a star in 1612-1613 – **Ans: Neptune**
3. Maria Celeste’s relationship with Galileo – **Ans: Daughter**
4. Person whom Galileo flattered by naming moons after him – **Ans: Cosimo II de’ Medici**
5. Fictitious structure whose size Galileo estimated in 1588 – **Ans: Dante’s Inferno**

Visual: **Simon Marius**

First contact:

Tamal Biswas | K.N. Viswanathan | Prem Nath Tiwari | Anan Rahim | Prem Nath Tiwari

For feedback and suggestions for ‘Science’, please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Daily page’

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Value of U.S. imports on which Canada has imposed tariffs

20 in \$ billion. Canada hit back at the U.S. on Tuesday with retaliatory tariffs on about \$20 billion worth of annual imports and rolled out aid for businesses and workers, matching the latest duties imposed by the Donald Trump administration dollar-for-dollar. REUTERS

Persons named by India for AFC U20 Asian Cup Qualifiers

23 India on Wednesday named a 23-member squad for the upcoming AFC U20 Asian Cup Qualifiers in Tashkent, after omitting eight players who were called for the national camp. The qualifying tournament will be held in the Uzbek capital from August 31 to September 6. PTI

Amount requested by Italy from EU's SAFE defence funds

8 in € billion. Italy has requested €8 billion from the European Union's SAFE funding programme, a source said on Wednesday, confirming earlier media reports. The SAFE instrument is a joint borrowing scheme backed by the EU aimed at boosting the bloc's defence capabilities. REUTERS

Private pharmacies under RGHS scheme facing action

215 Authorities have temporarily suspended 215 private pharmacies from processing transactions under the Rajasthan Government Health Scheme (RGHS) for alleged negligence and delays in dispensing medicines, officials said on Wednesday. PTI

Number of major South Delhi flyovers repaired by PWD

3 The Public Works Department (PWD) is planning to undertake repair and maintenance work on stretches of three major South Delhi flyovers, including Nehru Nagar, the AIIMS loops and Barapullah Phase 1, officials said on Wednesday. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

Follow us [facebook.com/thehindu](#) [X.com/the_hindu](#) [instagram.com/the_hindu](#)

Why was Parandur airport scrapped?

What were the main objections to the Parandur site? How much land had been acquired? What approvals had the plan secured? Why does Chennai need another airport? What will Terminal 5 add to Chennai airport's capacity? How soon can Chennai get a second airport?

EXPLAINER

Sunitha Sekar

The story so far:

Four years after it was announced, one of the most anticipated and controversial projects for Chennai city, the second airport proposed at Parandur, has now been scrapped by the Tamil Nadu government. Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay announced in the State Assembly on August 24 that the government would drop the project and look for an alternative site to build Chennai's second airport.

Meanwhile, the Airports Authority of India will construct Terminal 5 in the northwestern area of the airport, which passengers will be able to access via an elevated corridor. The existing Chennai airport at Meenambakkam handles 30 million passengers a year. With the ongoing construction of Terminal 3, which will also handle international flights along with Terminal 2, the airport's capacity will increase to 35 million passengers a year. If Terminal 5 is also completed, the airport's capacity will rise further to 55 million passengers a year.

When did the search begin?

The plan for a second airport for Chennai dates back to 1998, when the Ministry of Civil Aviation announced that the project was under consideration. The then Chief Minister, M. Karunanidhi, wrote to Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, requesting him to expedite the project's clearance. A site 10 km south of Meenambakkam was earmarked for the airport, which was to be developed under the Build-Own-Operate-Transfer model.

A year later, the Centre gave its nod for the project, which was planned to come up on 3,000 acres at an estimated cost of ₹2,000 crore. However, the project did not take off. In 2007, the Tamil Nadu government announced yet again that a second airport would be built, this time



The Tamil Nadu government revived the plan for a second airport in 2022 and announced that it would be built at Parandur in Kancheepuram district. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

over 4,820 acres at Sriperumbudur, with four runways. The site was emerging as a strong industrial and manufacturing corridor, and an airport there was seen as strategically important for the city's growth. But the project was embroiled in controversy, drawing fierce opposition from political parties and farmers who objected to their land being taken over for the project. The project too failed to progress, and the following decade saw only the existing airport at Meenambakkam undergo Phase I and Phase II modernisation.

The Tamil Nadu government revived the plan for a second airport in 2022 and announced that it would be built at Parandur in Kancheepuram district. Farmers in Ekanapuram, who faced relocation if the project became a reality, began staging protests.

In early 2025, a year after launching his party Tamilaga Vetti Kazhagam, Mr. Vijay visited the project site at Parandur to show solidarity with the protesting farmers. Keeping his promise, he announced earlier this week that the government would no longer pursue the

Parandur airport project.

Why did Parandur face opposition?

After the project was announced in 2022, landowners in several villages in and around Parandur opposed it, saying it would severely affect their livelihoods. Villagers in Ekanapuram also warned that the project could lead to an environmental disaster. Activists echoed these concerns, pointing out that the proposed site is interspersed with several water bodies. They said the construction of the airport could not only inundate nearby villages but also increase the risk of flooding in Chennai.

How far had the project progressed?

Over the last four years, the Tamil Nadu government secured some major approvals required to commence the project, including site clearance and in-principle approval from the Ministry of Civil Aviation.

Of the 5,846 acres required for the project, the government completed the acquisition of 1,802 acres. The State government, however, had not obtained

environmental clearance or floated bids to find a private operator.

Why does Chennai need another airport?

Nearly a decade ago, Chennai was the third-busiest airport in the country, after New Delhi and Kolkata. However, privately managed airports in Bengaluru and Hyderabad have recorded significant growth over the past decade and have overtaken Chennai to become the country's third- and fourth-busiest airports, respectively.

Bengaluru, in particular, has raised the benchmark for passenger experience, while adding direct flights to Paris, Amsterdam, Munich, Vietnam, Tokyo and the Maldives. Chennai airport, however, has yet to secure direct flights to any of these destinations. Passengers have also raised several concerns about the airport in recent years, including delays in opening a second cab pick-up point and completing Terminal 3, among others.

Industry experts have repeatedly stressed that an airport should no longer be viewed merely as transport infrastructure, but as an economic engine that can draw investments, companies and employment for a city and the State.

With Tamil Nadu turning into a \$1.5-trillion economy in the next 10 years, world-class airport infrastructure is the need of the hour, experts say.

What happens next?

With the Parandur airport project scrapped, the Tamil Nadu government is back to searching for an ideal site for Chennai's second airport. However, experts point out that finding a location without farmlands and water bodies in and around Chennai will be far from easy and that one must also look at the availability of airspace before arriving at a location.

Even if the process begins now, the earliest Chennai could get a second airport would be in five to seven years, depending on how quickly the clearances are granted by the Centre.

THE GIST

Tamil Nadu has scrapped the Parandur airport plan after sustained opposition from farmers over land acquisition, livelihoods and the site's water bodies, and will look for an alternative location.

Chennai's existing airport capacity is being expanded to 55 million passengers with Terminal 3 and the proposed Terminal 5, but experts say a second airport is crucial to support the city's economic growth.

The government now faces the challenge of finding a site with minimal impact on farmlands and water bodies, with a new airport unlikely to be ready for at least five to seven years.

How can States use disaster funds for heatwaves?

Heatwave funding expands, but States must strengthen planning and implementation to use it effectively

Shravan Prabhu

In August 4, the Ministry of Home Affairs told the Lok Sabha that heatwaves and lightning had been added to India's list of notified natural calamities, taking the total list to 14.

The change follows a recommendation by the Sixteenth Finance Commission (FC-XVI) and operational guidelines issued on June 30. Along with the 2024 amendment to the Disaster Mitigation Fund guidelines, the update means heatwaves are now eligible for the full State Disaster Risk Management Fund pool.

Disaster finance in India

Under Article 280 of the Constitution, the Finance Commission recommends arrangements for disaster management funds. The FC-XVI recommended ₹2.04 lakh crore for State disaster funds in the five years between 2026-27 and 2030-31,

nearly 28% more than the previous Commission's allocation.

Of the total fund, ₹1.6 lakh crore goes to the State Disaster Response Fund (SDRF) and the rest to the State Disaster Mitigation Fund (SDMF). The SDRF is meant for response, relief, and reconstruction immediately following a disaster; the SDMF is meant to fund interventions to reduce the risk of a climate event from turning into a disaster, in the longer term.

These funds are available to all States. The FC-XVI has determined the inter-State distribution using a formula comprising a disaster risk index, which takes into account the frequency and intensity of different hazards along with exposure and vulnerability and expenses incurred by States during the previous commission's tenure. The FC-XVI recommended ₹79,406 crore for national disaster funds over the same period and which States can seek when a disaster is severe enough to exceed their own resources, like Kerala

did following the Wayanad landslides in 2024.

Heat has thus far occupied an awkward position in the disaster finance system. A State could notify a heatwave as a 'local disaster' and use the SDRF – but only up to 10% of its annual allocation and after setting separate norms such as the amount of compensation for loss of lives or damage to crops. Other notified disasters such as floods and cyclones faced no such ceiling. The new notification removes this asymmetry.

India's exposure to extreme heat is growing. The author used 35 indicators across climate change, exposure, and vulnerability to estimate that more than 57% of Indian districts, home to roughly three-fourths of the Indian population, face high- to very-high heat risk. The number of hot days per year has increased. The incidence of very warm nights and relative humidity has also risen, reducing the human body's ability to recover after hot days.

What States can fund

The National Disaster Management Authority has asked all States, districts, and cities to develop heat action plans (HAPs), which map heat risk and vulnerability and identify short-, medium-, and long-term interventions. Thus far, 300 cities and districts across 23 heatwave-prone States have HAPs.

Implementation, however, has lagged because of limited technical capacity, competing priorities, and inadequate funding. A 2023 review of HAPs also found that 79% of the plans asked city departments to self-allocate funds.

The new Central notification provides States with two clearer financing options. Under the SDRF, they can provide relief and compensation for heat-related losses. And through the SDMF, they can finance longer-term risk reduction such as cooling shelters and early-warning systems. The respective State Disaster Management Authorities and State Emergency Operations Centre will be the nodal agencies responsible for both funds' corpus.

Next steps

First, heat planning must expand. Twelve States have already notified heatwaves locally but only some 300 cities and districts have HAPs, leaving around 4,800 urban local bodies and 800 districts without them. Heat-specific SDMF guidelines are still awaited, but existing guidelines require risk and vulnerability

assessments before any projects are proposed – precisely the groundwork HAPs are meant to provide.

Second, plans must become fundable projects. States need model mitigation proposals suited to local climate and geography. Many local bodies lack the technical capacity to prepare such proposals. Research institutions, NGOs, and philanthropy could provide technical support and risk capital to help convert plans into appraisable projects.

Third, health surveillance must improve. Relief payouts will now depend on accurate loss-and-damage data. The Health Ministry's current surveillance system covers over 51,000 reporting units and recorded 4,853 heatstroke cases and 20 confirmed heatstroke deaths between March 1 and July 26. But it misses the wider burden from heart, lung, and kidney conditions worsened by heat.

Fourth, States should link heat solutions to other government development schemes by identifying convergence, and use fast, pre-agreed tools like parametric insurance, which pays out automatically once a set temperature threshold is crossed. Similar tools already operate for other hazards; Nagaland, for example, has rainfall insurance that pays out when rainfall levels cross a set threshold. (Shravan Prabhu is Programme Lead at Council on Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW) and Coordinator of the GHHIN South Asia Heat & Health Hub)

